

Ether User Manual

Version 4.6.70

Ether Technologies

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This manual follows Ether's own menus. Each chapter says what a part of Ether is for, where to find it, and how to use it step by step. The **Plan** line under a chapter says which plans include it: **Local**, **Live 128**, **Live 320** or **Network** (see *Your plan* in Chapter 1).

1. Getting started

What it's for

This chapter takes you from a new computer to the main screen. Everything in Ether hangs off your Ether account: your account carries your plan, your plan carries your stations, and your stations carry their logs and music libraries. The computer is only a terminal. Sign in on any computer and your stations come with you. This chapter covers installing Ether, signing in, setting up or picking your stations, choosing your profile, updating Ether, and signing out.

Where to find it

- **Install:** run the Ether installer (**Ether Setup** *version* **.exe** on Windows, a **.dmg** on Mac).
- **Sign in:** the first screen every time you open Ether.
- **Profiles:** the **Select your profile** screen after sign-in. Manage them in **File** → **Settings** → **Station** → **Users & Security**.
- **Switch station:** the station button at the bottom-left of the main screen.
- **Updates:** the update card at the bottom-right, or **Help** → **Check for Updates**.
- **Sign out: File** → **Sign Out**.

Plan: Local (every plan). New accounts start with a 15-day trial; no card is needed. Pulling stations or music down from the cloud needs Live 128, Live 320 or Network (see each step below).

1. Install Ether

On Windows

1. Double-click **Ether Setup** *version* **.exe**.
2. The installer asks where to install. Keep the suggested folder or choose your own.
3. Finish the installer. It puts an **Ether** shortcut on the desktop and in the Start menu.

On a Mac

1. Open the Ether **.dmg** file.
2. Drag Ether into your Applications folder.

2. Sign in (every time you open Ether)

When you open Ether you see a short start-up screen, then the sign-in screen. **The sign-in screen always comes first.** Nothing else in Ether opens until an account is signed in. Once you are in, you stay in for as long as Ether runs; the sign-in renews itself in the background.

1. Open Ether.
2. Make sure **Sign in** is selected at the top.
3. Type your **Email address** and **Password**.
4. Leave **Remember me** ticked to keep this computer signed in while Ether runs. **File** → **Sign Out** ends it.
5. Press **Sign in** (or press Enter in the password box).

Forgot password? under the button opens the password reset page in your web browser.

If something goes wrong, the screen says why, in plain words. For example:

- **Email or password is incorrect.**
- **Couldn't reach the server to load your stations.** Check your internet connection and try again.
- **This account's devices are full.** Free up a device, then sign in again.

New to Ether? Create an account

1. On the sign-in screen, choose **Sign up**.
2. Type **Your name (optional)**, your **Email address**, and a password of 8 or more characters.
3. Optional: type a handle for your public station page (the box that starts **listen.ether-technologies.com/@**). The screen tells you if it is **Available**, **Already taken**, or not allowed. You can also set it later.
4. Press **Create account & continue**. Your trial starts right away.

3. Your stations on this computer

What happens next depends on what your account already has.

Your account has no stations yet

Ether asks you to create one.

1. **Name your new station.** Type the **Station name**. **Nickname**, **Frequency** and **Call letters** are optional.
2. Press **Create station**.
3. **How do you want to broadcast?** Pick **Solo**, **Standard** or **Live Radio**, then **Continue**. You can change this later in Settings.
4. **What are you using Ether for?** Pick the closest match (Radio Station, Venue / Attraction, Retail / Business, House of Worship, Podcast / YouTube), then **Continue**.
5. **Name your station.** Check the **Station name** and add a **Tagline** if you like. This shows in the header and on your Now Playing screen. Press **Continue**.
6. **Add your music.** Choose one:
   - **From this computer** — pick a folder. Ether matches files by name and links the ones it recognises.
   - **From the cloud** — downloads your cloud music library. **Plan:** Live 128, Live 320 or Network.
   - **Skip for now** — add music later through the Library.

Your account already has stations

You see **Sync your stations to this computer**, with a card for each of your stations. All of them are ticked to start with.

1. Tick the stations this computer should have. **Select all** / **Clear all** appear when you have more than one.
2. If someone has given you access to their stations, they appear under **AVAILABLE TO YOU**. Tick any you want on this computer. **Plan:** Live 128, Live 320 or Network (account members).
3. Press **Sync** *(number)* **selected**.
4. **Where should we keep your music?** Keep **Default app folder** or press **Choose folder...**, then press **Install here**.

5. Ether shows **Getting your station ready on this computer** with a percentage. Your stations, profiles, colour theme, shows and rotation schedules come down from the cloud, and the music library downloads once for all of them. When it finishes, Ether restarts into your stations.

If setup does not finish, the screen says **Setup didn't finish** and offers **Retry**.

Other choices on this screen:

- **+ Create new station** — make a new station instead (the steps in the section above).
- **Skip** — go on without pulling anything down.

Plan: pulling your stations from the cloud uses Cloud backup and the Cloud music library: Live 128, Live 320 or Network.

If the stations are already on this computer (for example after reinstalling Ether), Ether opens them straight away without downloading anything.

4. Choose your profile

After your account is signed in, you choose who is working. A **profile** is a person who uses this copy of Ether, such as "Admin" or "Jeff". Profiles have nothing to do with your account. They live on this computer.

The first time

There are no profiles yet, so Ether asks you to make one.

1. Under **Set up your profile**, type a **Profile title** (for example your name). It starts as "Admin".
2. Type a 4-digit **PIN (4 digits)**, then type it again in **Confirm PIN**.
3. Press **Create profile & continue**.

Every time after that

1. Under **Select your profile**, click your name. Each card shows the profile's role and **PIN required** or **No PIN**.
2. If the profile has a PIN, type it on the number pad or on your keyboard. Ether checks it as soon as you type the fourth digit.
3. A wrong PIN shows **Incorrect PIN** and clears the dots. ← **Back** (or Esc) returns to the list.

A profile with no PIN opens as soon as you click it.

Roles

Each profile has a role: **Administrator**, **Music Director** or **On-Air Jock**. Today the role is a label. It does not limit what the profile can see or do.

Start your shift

After the profile, you see the **On Shift** screen: who is on shift, what is on air now and coming up, station health, and **Personal Notes** (type a note; it saves itself). Press **Start My Shift** → to open the main screen.

Change profile while Ether is running

Click the **person** button in the top bar, next to **AUTO**. You go back to **Select your profile**. Your account stays signed in.

Add or change profiles

Open **File** → **Settings** → **Station** → **Users & Security**.

- **+ Add User** — type a **Name**, pick a role and a colour, and an optional 4-digit PIN. Press **Create User**.
- **Edit** — change the name, role or colour, then **Save**.
- **Set PIN** / **Change PIN** — type a new 4-digit PIN twice and press **Save PIN**. Leave both boxes empty and press **Save PIN** to take the PIN away.

5. Your stations after sign-in

The station button at the bottom-left of the main screen shows the station you are working on (its call sign, or the start of its name) with a green dot.

1. Click it to see your stations. The one you are in has a tick.
2. Click another station to switch to it. A note says **Switched to** *(name)*.
3. **New Station…** opens a form: **Station Name** (required), **Callsign**, and its **ICECAST SETTINGS** (**Server URL**, **Mount**, **Password**, **Bitrate**, **Format**). Press **Create Station**.
4. **Manage Stations…** opens the Station Manager.

Stations other accounts have shared with you are listed under **ACCESSIBLE VIA YOUR ACCOUNT**. They are view-only here.

Plan: Local (every plan).

6. Updating Ether

Ether checks for a new version about 10 seconds after it starts, and every 30 minutes while it runs.

1. When there is a new version, a card appears at the bottom-right: **Ether** *(version)* **is ready**, with notes about the release.
2. Press **Update Now**. The card shows **Downloading update…** and its progress.
3. When it says **Update downloaded**, press **Restart & Update**.
4. **Then close Ether completely and open it again.** The audio engine runs separately from the window and does not restart with an update. To close completely, use **File** → **Quit Ether**, or close the window and choose **Stop & Quit Ether**.

Later hides the card for now. A downloaded update also installs the next time Ether quits.

To check yourself, use **Help** → **Check for Updates**. If a newer version exists, the same card appears. If you are up to date, nothing appears.

If the audio engine is still the old version, a yellow bar across the top says so: **The audio engine is running an older build … fully close and reopen Ether.** It stays until you do.

7. Signing out

1. Choose **File** → **Sign Out**.
2. Ether asks **Sign out?** — "Ether will close completely, including the audio engine. Reopen it to sign in."
3. Press **Sign Out**.

Ether closes completely. Nothing is deleted. Your stations, library and settings are kept for this account, and signing back in opens them exactly as you left them. To use a different account on this computer, sign out, open Ether again and sign in as the other account. Each account keeps its own stations; neither can see the other's.

8. Your plan

Your plan comes from your Ether account. You never type a license key: signing in with your account's email and password is all Ether needs. To see your plan, open ☰ → **Plans & Subscription** (or press the plan name in the top bar).

Plan	What it's for
Local	The full desktop app on every computer, streaming to your own Icecast server. No cloud features.
Live 128	One hosted station at 128 kbps, plus every cloud feature: web dashboard, remote control, sync between computers, cloud backup and the cloud music library.
Live 320	The same as Live 128, at up to 320 kbps.
Network	Every feature, for a group of stations.

Prices are shown in **Plans & Subscription**, monthly or yearly (two months free on a yearly plan). New accounts start with a 15-day free trial; no card is needed. To change plans, press **Choose** on a plan there, or go to your account page in a web browser.

9. Billing notices

If something needs your attention about your plan, a small notice appears at the top right of Ether, for example:

- your free trial ends soon, or has ended;
- a payment failed;
- your card has expired or is about to.

Each notice says what happened and has a button to fix it (it opens your account page). **Later** hides it.

- The same notice shows **at most once a day**. A different, more serious notice shows right away.
- **A billing notice never stops playout.** Your station keeps playing; only the cloud features pause if a trial or plan has ended.
- After you fix it (for example, update your card), the notice goes away on its own.

Good to know

- **No account, no Ether.** Until an account is signed in, the sign-in screen is the only screen.

- **Signing out stops the audio.** A signed-out account does not broadcast. Take the station off air before you sign out.
- **One exception to "sign in first":** if the computer restarts while a station is streaming live, Ether comes back on air by itself without waiting for a sign-in.
- **Closing the window is not quitting.** Closing the main window asks what to do: **Keep Playing in Tray** (audio keeps going; find Ether in the system tray), **Stop & Quit Ether**, or **Cancel**. If the tray icon could not be made, the choices are only **Stop & Quit Ether** and **Cancel**.
- **Solo, Standard and Live Radio** is stored for the station but does not change which decks the board shows. You set the board up yourself (see *Decks and the board*).

2. The main screen

What it's for

The main screen is where you run the station. It shows what is playing and what is next, the board with its faders, and the controls you need on air. Everything else opens beside it in its own window, so the live view stays on screen. This chapter is a map: what each part of the screen is, and where every menu entry and button goes.

Where to find it

It opens when you press **Start My Shift** → after choosing your profile. From anywhere in Ether you can come back to it by clicking the clock in the middle of the top bar, or by choosing ☰ → **Return to Mixer** when another screen is showing.

Plan: Local (every plan). Streaming through Ether's own stream server needs Live 128, Live 320 or Network (see *The ON AIR button* below).

The layout

From top to bottom:

1. **The top bar** — show name, search, the clock, and the main controls (AUTO, ON AIR, ☰).
2. **The middle** — the play queue (**Up Next**) on one side and **the board** (the faders, then **Master Out**) on the other. Drag the divider between them to change their widths. Drag a panel by its edge to swap the two sides. The small arrow at the queue's inner edge collapses the queue to a thin strip that reads **QUEUE · *(count)***; click the strip to open it again. When the queue is empty it says **Queue empty** and "*Drag carts here, or generate the hour in Schedule*".
3. **The dock** — when you open a bottom-bar tab such as CATEGORIES or LIBRARY, it opens under the board. Drag the bar above it up or down to share the space.
4. **The bottom bar** — the station button, health lights, the view tabs, DELAY and DUMP.

The top bar

Left side

- **Sync off** — appears only when sync is switched off on this computer. Hover for the reason; Settings turns it back on.
- **Show name** — the show on air now, in its colour. It appears only while a show is on air. Click it to return to the main screen.
- **Search** — type to search your library. On a narrow screen it becomes a magnifying-glass button that opens the Library.

Middle

- **The clock.** Click it to return to the main screen.

Right side, left to right

- **VIDEO LIVE** — appears while the Show+ video engine is live. Click it to go to Show+.
- **Upgrade** (purple, with a star) — appears when your plan does not include the cloud features. It opens your plan and subscription page.
- **The person button** — your profile. Click it to change profile (you go back to **Select your profile**; your account stays signed in).
- **AUTO / MANUAL** — the automation switch. ● **AUTO** (green) means Ether is running the station. **MANUAL** means you are. **AUTO ?** with a dashed border means Ether is still waiting for the audio engine to report. See *Running the show*.
- **ON AIR / OFF AIR** — the stream button. See below.
- ☰ — the menu. See below.

The ON AIR button

This button shows the real state of this station's stream, and starts or stops it.

- **OFF AIR** — not streaming. Click to start streaming.
- **GOING LIVE…** (amber) — connecting.
- ● **ON AIR** (red) — streaming. Click to stop broadcasting.

It always shows the station you are working on. If another of your stations is streaming, this button still says OFF AIR for the station on screen.

It streams to the stream server set for the station (its Icecast settings: server, mount, password, bitrate). See *Streaming*.

Plan: your own Icecast server: Local (every plan). Ether's hosted stream: Live 128, Live 320 or Network.

The ☰ menu

Click ☰ at the far right of the top bar. A panel slides in from the right. Click outside it, press **Esc**, or press ✕ to close it. Entries you use often get a star.

Almost every entry opens **its own window** beside the main screen, so the live view never goes away. If that window is already open, Ether brings it to the front instead of opening a second one. Windows remember where you put them.

Entry	What it opens
Return to Mixer	Shown only when another screen is covering the main screen. Brings the main screen back.
Library	The Library window. See *Library*.
Schedule	The Clocks window. See *Categories, clocks and shows*.
Imaging	The Imaging window. See *Imaging: sweepers, jingles and carts*.
Program Log	The Program Log window. See *The schedule and the Program Log*.
Play Log	The Play Log window (what actually aired). See *Logs and reports*.
Schedule Manager	The Schedule Manager window.
Rotation Analytics	The Rotation Analytics window.
Patch Bay	The Patch Bay window, where outputs and inputs are patched. See *Streaming*.
Stream Manager	The Stream Manager window: the station's stream, its status, listeners and listen-live link. See *Streaming*.
Health Monitor	The Health Monitor window. See *Health Monitor and System Health*.
Announcements	The Announcements window.
EAS Logbook	The EAS Logbook window. See *Announcements and the EAS Logbook*.
Carts	The Carts window (your cart wall).
Decks	The board (all faders and Master Out) in its own window.
Processor	The master processor rack window.
Shows	The Shows window.
Voice Tracker	The Voice Tracker window. See *Voice Tracker*.
Categories	The Categories window.
Jukebox	The public Jukebox display, full screen. See *Jukebox*.
Show+	The Show+ video studio window.
Show+ DAW	The Show+ DAW window.
Screens	A new Screen window. See *Screens*.
Remote Link	**Settings** → **Remote Link**. See *Remote Link*.
Desk	The Producer Desk window.
Now Playing	Asks which station to show, then opens the Now Playing window. Picking a station other than the one on screen **switches Ether to that station** first.
Phone	The Phone Desk in its own window. See *Phone Desk*.
Live Captions	The Live Captions screen, in the main window (not a separate window).
Theme Studio	The colour theme picker.

The bottom bar

From left to right:

- **The station button** — the station you are working on. Click it to switch station, add one or manage them (see *Getting started*).
- **The system light** — green **NOMINAL** when Ether's database and keep-on-air are healthy; **WARN**, **ERROR** or **ALARM** when not. Click it to open the Health Monitor.
- **The catalogue light** — **CATALOGUE OK** when every music file resolves on this computer. It shows **MISSING**, **OUTSIDE** or **RELINKED** with a count when files are not where they should be. Hover for the details; click to open the Health Monitor.
- **CLEAR** ▾ — appears when the queue has items. See *Running the show*.
- **The view tabs** (below).
- **DELAY** and **DUMP** — the broadcast (profanity) delay. See *Running the show*.

The view tabs

Click a tab to open it; click it again to close it. Only one dock is open at a time. The open tab is lit.

Tab	What it does
DECKS	Opens **Configure Decks**. See *Decks and the board*.
CARTS	Opens the cart wall under the board. If one of your deck slots is already set to a Cart Wall, the tab is dimmed and the push-up stays closed; hover for the reason.
SHOWS	Shows, docked under the board.
CLOCKS	Clocks, docked under the board.
CATEGORIES	Categories, docked under the board.
SWEEPERS	The sweeper editor (pools, assignments, Reel Splitter), docked under the board, with **OPEN IMAGING** → for the full Imaging window.
SPOTS	Opens the Spots screen in place of the main screen. Click the clock (or ☰ → Return to Mixer) to come back.
LIBRARY	The Library, docked under the board.
PROGRAM LOG	The Program Log, docked under the board.
PHONE	The Phone Desk, docked under the board.

On a narrow screen the tabs fold into a ☰ button at the bottom-right. Click it for the same list.

The menu bar

The menu bar at the top of the window (File, View, Library, Schedule, Tools, Help) reaches the same screens and more. When you choose an item from the main window, its screen opens in the main window. When you choose it while a pop-out window is in front, it opens as its own window instead, so the board is not covered.

- **File** — **New Session** (returns to the main screen), **Import Music…**, **Settings**, **Sign Out**, **Quit Ether**.

- **View** — **Play Queue** (hide or show the queue), **Configure Decks...**, **Reset to Default**, **Reload**, **Toggle DevTools**.
- **Library** — Library, Spots & Promos, Voice Tracker, Import from Folder..., Cue Editor.
- **Schedule** — Clocks, Shows & Dayparts, Categories, Program Log, Play Log, Rotation Analytics, Schedule Manager, Announcements, EAS Logbook.
- **Tools** — Voice Tracker, Show+ DAW, Show+, Cue Editor, Clip Editor, Import Library..., Stream Manager, Smart Scheduler, Listener Analytics, Cloud Log Backup, Patch Bay, Station Manager, System Health, and **Monitors**.
- **Help** — see *Keyboard shortcuts, Help and About*.

Pop-out windows: Tools → Monitors

Tools → **Monitors** opens parts of the station in their own windows, for a second screen:

Decks (the whole board), **Show+**, **Queue / Up Next**, **Station Health**, **Mic**, **Master Output**, **Processor**, **Imaging**, **Phone Desk**, **Voice Tracker**.

The pop-out board is the same board as the main screen. A fader moved in one moves in the other.

View → Configure Decks and Reset to Default

- **View** → **Configure Decks...** opens the same **Configure Decks** panel as the **DECKS** tab.
- **View** → **Reset to Default** shows the play queue again (if you hid it with **View** → **Play Queue**) and returns to the main screen. It does not change your decks or faders.
- **View** → **Play Queue** hides or shows the queue. This is not remembered: the queue is back the next time Ether opens.

Good to know

- **Nothing on the ☰ menu covers the live view**, except **Live Captions**, which opens in the main window. Live Captions listens to an audio input, and only one window can use that input at a time.
- **View** → **Reload** (Ctrl + R) reloads the window. While Ether is running you stay signed in to your account: the window comes back without the sign-in screen.
- **Master Out** → **Station** → **Stream** shows this station's real stream state: **ON AIR**, **CONNECTING**, **ERROR** or **OFF**. It is the same state Stream Manager shows.
- **Toggle DevTools (F12)** opens developer tools for the window in front. It is for troubleshooting with support.
- **SPOTS is the one tab that replaces the main screen.** All the others dock under the board.

3. Decks and the board

What it's for

The board is Ether's mixing desk. It works like a broadcast console: every channel has a fader for its level and an **ON** button that opens or cuts it. Decks A, B and C play your music. Source channels carry everything else: a microphone, sweepers, carts, the jukebox, or a feed from another Ether computer. On the right, **Master Out** sets what goes to air and what you hear in the room.

Where to find it

- **The board:** the main screen, beside the play queue.
- **The board in its own window:** ☰ → **Decks**, or **Tools** → **Monitors** → **Decks**.
- **Choose deck types:** the **DECKS** tab in the bottom bar, or **View** → **Configure Decks...**.
- **Add a source channel:** the **+** after the last fader.
- **Master Out:** the panel at the right of the board. **Tools** → **Monitors** → **Master Output** opens it in its own window.

Plan: Local (every plan). Two sources use the cloud: the **Jukebox** source needs Live 128, Live 320 or Network; a **Link** paired through Ether needs Live 128, Live 320 or Network (a Link set up by typed address is Local).

The music decks: A, B and C

Decks A, B and C are the music decks. Automation plays from them in turn, and the Library's **A**, **B** and **C** buttons load onto them.

- Each deck has its own colour: A blue, B green, C purple. The same colours mark the deck rows in Up Next and the A/B/C buttons in the Library.
- The bar at the top of a deck strip shows its role. The deck on air fills from left to right as the song plays. The deck that plays next pulses.
- Under the fader: **ON** and **PFL** (below), and **EQ**, which opens that channel's EQ rack (see *Streaming*).

One strip or three

The narrow **A·B·C** tab before Deck A collapses the three decks into one strip. That strip shows the deck that started most recently, and the next deck rotates in when it starts. Press **EXPAND** on the strip to show all three again. Collapsing only changes the view: all three decks keep playing, metering and responding to their faders.

Faders

Every fader works the same way.

1. **Drag** the fader to set the level. Hold **Shift** while dragging for fine moves.
2. **Mouse wheel** or the **arrow keys** step it up or down.
3. **Double-click** sets it to 0 dB (unity).

4. Press **Enter** on a fader to type a level.

Your fader is your level. Loading a track does not move it, turning the channel OFF and ON does not move it, and Ether puts every fader back where it was after a restart. Level changes glide instead of jumping, so nothing clicks.

ON and PFL

ON is the channel's on/off switch.

- On a **music deck**, **ON** starts the deck. It is the only control that starts a deck. See *Running the show* for exactly how it behaves.
- On a **source channel**, **ON** opens the channel (lit blue) or cuts it. Cutting it never moves the fader. A new source channel comes up ON.

PFL lets you hear a channel before it goes to air: before its fader and ON, after its EQ, in this station's local output. The programme there dips while PFL is on. PFL is never on air. Press **PFL** again to turn it off. **Settings → Audio → PFL (pre-fader listen)** sets how far the programme dips.

Source channels

A source channel is a fader whose input you choose, like the source selector on a console. The channel is generic: what feeds it is your choice.

Add a source channel

1. Press **+** after the last fader.
2. A new strip appears, labelled **SOURCE** with its letter, and comes up **ON**.
3. When every source channel is in use, **+** is greyed out ("Every source channel is already on the board").

Choose what feeds it

Use the dropdown at the top of the strip:

Choice	What it does
— no source —	Nothing is patched.
Jukebox	The public request jukebox plays on this channel. This channel starts **OFF**, because it faces the public. See *Jukebox*.
Sweeper	Sweepers air on this channel — the log's sweepers between songs and the ones you fire by hand. See *Imaging: sweepers, jingles and carts*.
Cart / SFX rack	Your cart wall plays on this channel. With no channel set to this, carts play on Ether's built-in cart channel.
Link (network feed)	A feed from another Ether computer comes into this fader. See *Remote Link*.
Mic — pick an input… and **INPUT DEVICES (this computer)**	A microphone on this computer. See *The mic* below.

DUCK

DUCK ON makes the music dip while this channel has audio, and rise again when it goes quiet. **DUCK OFF** lets the channel mix over the music at full level. The setting is under the source dropdown. A second **DUCK** button just above the channel's **EQ** button sets the same thing (lit amber = on). How far and how fast the music dips is set in **Settings** → **Audio** → **Ducker**.

DUCK is on every source channel, whatever feeds it. Decks A, B and C have no DUCK; the music is what gets ducked.

Remove a source channel

Press the small **−** at the top-right of the strip. The channel leaves the board, its mic or Link is unpatched, and anything playing on it stops. If Ether cannot remove it, the strip shows the reason in red.

The mic

A microphone is a source channel patched to a microphone. It goes on air through the same engine as the music, with its own meter, EQ, fader and ON.

1. Find a source channel, or add one with **+**.
2. In its dropdown, under **INPUT DEVICES (this computer)**, choose your microphone or audio interface. (**Mic — pick an input…** sets the channel to Mic without choosing a device yet.)
3. The line under the dropdown shows the mic's state, for example **● IN 1 · +0 dB · live**. If it shows **no input — Settings** → **Audio**, the mic has no input yet.
4. Bring the fader up and press **ON**.
5. To have the music dip while you talk, set **DUCK ON**.

Click the state line to open **Settings** → **Audio**. Its **Mic Inputs (on air)** section is where you set the input number and gain. ☰ → **Patch Bay** chooses the input too; it is the same setting. If a device is unplugged, the dropdown shows it as *(not connected)* and the meter reads **NOT FED** instead of a flat zero.

Configure Decks

Open it with the **DECKS** tab or **View** → **Configure Decks…**.

1. Each slot is listed with its letter. Click a type to give the slot that type and turn it on:
   - **Music** — a music deck strip.
   - **Source** — a source channel with the dropdown described above.
   - **Cart** — a cart wall in that slot.
   - **Desk** — the Producer Desk in that slot.
   - **Video Studio** — Show+ in that slot.
   - **Jukebox** — offered on source slots only.
2. The switch at the right of each slot turns it on or off. Up to 6 slots can be on at once; the counter shows how many (for example **4/6**).
3. Press **Apply Layout** to save. **Cancel** closes without saving.

Reset Default puts the board back to the starting layout straight away: decks A, B and C on, the other slots off. Source channels you added are removed from the board.

Only decks A, B and C are played by automation and loaded by the Library's A/B/C buttons. For a mic, sweepers, carts or the jukebox, use a source channel (**+**).

Show presets (the SHOW bar)

The bar across the top of the board saves and recalls the whole board as a named show.

1. **Arm a show…** — pick a saved show. Nothing changes yet. ▾ lists exactly what will change.
2. **TAKE** ▸ *(name)* — channels that are OFF change now. Channels that are ON keep what they have, and their ON button flashes amber and says **PENDING** until you switch them OFF. **TAKE NOW** on a channel applies it immediately (its level glides, no click).
3. **DISARM** cancels an armed show.
4. **SAVE** overwrites the current show with the board as it is. **SAVE AS…** saves it under a new name. The built-in **Flat** show cannot be overwritten.

A Take never switches a channel ON. • **modified** next to the show name means the board has changed since the show was taken.

Master Out

The panel at the right of the board.

- **Bus meters** — the programme, local, stream and monitor levels, measured after the faders.
- **Master** — the broadcast level: what listeners hear. Pull it down and the audience hears it quieter.
- **Monitor** — the level in your room. Turn it down and the room goes quiet while the station keeps broadcasting at full level.
- **Limiter** — how hard the limiter is working.
- **Master EQ** → **OPEN** and **Processor** → **OPEN** — open the master rack in its own window. See *Streaming*.
- **Station** — On Air (LIVE or STBY), Uptime and Next Break. Click the heading to show or hide it.
- **Send feed** — the Remote Link sender. See *Remote Link*.
- **Station monitor strips** — a speaker level and mute for each station on this computer. These change only what you hear in the room, never the broadcast.
- The arrow at the top-left collapses Master Out to a thin meter strip; the arrow at the top opens it again. The small square-and-arrow button opens Master Out in its own window.

MASTER is heard by everyone. MONITOR is heard by you.

Good to know

- **Monitor starts silent on a new computer.** Until you set it once, the Monitor fader is at off and the room is quiet. After that, Ether remembers it.
- **Master and Monitor are remembered** and put back if the audio engine restarts.
- **The board in its own window is the same board.** A fader moved in one window moves in the other.
- **A fader with no strip cannot be on air.** If the audio engine is carrying a channel the board does not list, Ether adds a strip for it so you can see and control it.
- **No key starts a deck.** Only ON does.

4. Running the show

What it's for

This chapter covers the moment-to-moment work of being on air: letting Ether run the station (AUTO) or running it yourself (MANUAL), reading what is coming up, putting songs on the decks, starting a deck, and using the broadcast delay to keep something off the air.

Where to find it

- **AUTO / MANUAL:** the button in the top bar, left of ON AIR. Keyboard: **A**.
- **Up Next (the play queue):** beside the board on the main screen. **Tools** → **Monitors** → **Queue / Up Next** opens it in its own window.
- **Loading a deck:** the **A**, **B** and **C** buttons in the Library.
- **Starting a deck:** the deck's **ON** button on the board.
- **CLEAR ▾:** the bottom bar, when the queue has items.
- **DELAY** and **DUMP:** the right side of the bottom bar.

Plan: Local (every plan).

AUTO and MANUAL

AUTO means Ether runs the station: it follows the Program Log, cues the next songs on the decks, plays them in turn, and fires spots and sweepers. **MANUAL** means you run it.

The button always shows the current state:

- ● **AUTO** (green) — automation is on.
- **MANUAL** — you are in control.
- **AUTO ?** (dashed border) — Ether is waiting for the audio engine to report. Click it to turn AUTO on.

Turn AUTO on

1. Click **MANUAL** (or press **A**).
2. The button turns green and reads ● **AUTO**. Ether loads the queue from the Program Log, starting from the song scheduled for now, and starts playing.

If nothing is scheduled for the next two hours, Ether is meant to ask: "Nothing is scheduled to play right now. Auto-populate the queue with rotation-eligible songs?" **OK** fills the queue with songs from your rotation and starts. **Cancel** — or no question at all — leaves the button on **MANUAL** and opens the Program Log under the board, so you can build the day with Fill Day (see *The schedule and the Program Log*).

Turn AUTO off

1. Click ● **AUTO** (or press **A**).
2. The button reads **MANUAL**. The song on air finishes. After it, nothing advances on its own: no next song, no spots, no sweepers.

In MANUAL, nothing is cued for you. You load and start every deck yourself.

Up Next

Up Next is what plays after the song on air, in the Program Log's order.

The deck rows (top). Three rows, one per music deck, in the deck colours (A blue, B green, C purple):

- The deck **on air** fills from left to right as the song plays, and shows the time played and the song's length.
- The deck **playing next** pulses.
- In the **last 10 seconds** of the song on air, its row flashes and the time turns amber, so you know when to talk.
- A deck holding a **spot** has a pulsing amber frame until the spot ends.
- A sweeper due on a seam shows as its own row (**SWP**) above the song it introduces. If its audio is not on this computer, it says **FILE MISSING — WILL NOT PLAY**.

The list (below). The songs still to come, each with its title, artist and length. Spots carry a **SPOT** badge. Scheduled announcements appear at the time they will fire. A song placed earlier than your separation rules allow shows ⚠ **separation** · *(minutes)* **early**.

When the queue is empty, it says **Queue empty**.

Take a song out

1. Find the song in Up Next.
2. Click its ✕ (or right-click it and choose **Remove**).

The song comes out of the Program Log too, not just off the list, so it does not come back and does not air. If it was already cued on a deck, the deck is emptied and cued with the next song. The song on air cannot be removed here; use its deck's **ON** button. A row that already aired is the record of what happened and is never touched.

Right-clicking a song also offers the same song actions you get on a deck or in the Library (such as edit and show in library).

To change the running order of later songs, edit the Program Log. Up Next is re-read from the log every few seconds.

CLEAR ▾

When the queue has items, **CLEAR** ▾ appears in the bottom bar. It offers:

- **Reset to schedule** — re-syncs playout and re-cues the idle decks from the log.
- **Clear & regenerate** — rewrites the log from now on. The hour in progress is spared.

Loading a deck

1. Open the Library (the **LIBRARY** tab, ☰ → **Library**, or press **L**).
2. Find the song.
3. Press **A**, **B** or **C** on its row (or right-click it and choose **Load to Deck A**, **B** or **C**).

4. While it loads, a note says **Loading "**…**" onto** *(deck)*….

Q on the row (or **Add to Queue**) adds the song to the bottom of Up Next instead. It becomes a row of the Program Log added by hand, and nothing automatic removes it.

Ether never loads over a deck that is on air. If the deck is playing or paused, nothing is loaded and a note says: **Deck** *(X)* **is on air — "**…**" was not loaded. Stop deck** *(X)* **first.** If the song's file cannot be found, the note says so (for example **unavailable, needs re-import**).

Starting a deck: ON

ON is how you put a deck on air, and it is the only button that does it.

Start a cued deck

1. Make sure the deck has a song on it (the deck shows a title).
2. Press that deck's **ON** on the board.
3. The deck goes on air. If another deck was playing, it comes off almost at once.

You do not need to stop the other deck first, and you do not need to leave AUTO. In AUTO, the next songs re-cue behind you and the log carries on from the song you started.

Turn a deck off

Press **ON** on the deck that is playing. The deck goes silent at once. This is a stop, not a pause: the deck goes back to idle. To hear that song again, load it again.

Start from silence

If nothing is playing, press **ON** on any cued deck. It starts.

How ON behaves

- **The takeover is a quick cut, not a fade.** When you press ON to take over, the outgoing song is cut after about a third of a second. You reach for ON in a hurry for a wrong song, a bad file or bad language, and that audio needs to be gone. Automatic song-to-song segues in AUTO are not affected; they keep their normal overlap.
- **ON does not touch your faders.**
- **Pressing twice does no harm.** A second press on a deck that is already starting is ignored. You cannot put two decks on air by pressing quickly.
- **An empty deck does not start.** Load a song first.

Esc

Esc closes things. It never stops audio. It closes the ☰ menu, the shortcut list, Configure Decks, dialogs and open lists. Nothing on air changes when you press it.

The broadcast delay: DELAY and DUMP

The broadcast delay holds your stream a few seconds behind what you hear in the studio. If something goes wrong — bad language from a caller, say — you can press **DUMP** to throw that audio away before listeners hear it.

The delay is on the **stream** only. Your studio speakers stay live, so you hear everything first.

Arm the delay

1. Press **DELAY** in the bottom bar.
2. It turns amber and reads **DELAY 8s**. A small bar beside it fills as the delay builds up.
3. When the bar is full (it turns green), the stream is 8 seconds behind the studio and **DUMP** is ready.

Dump

1. Press **DUMP** (red when ready).
2. The audio held in the delay is dropped and the stream jumps to live.
3. The delay stays armed and builds back up by itself. **DUMP** is ready again when the bar is full.

DUMP is greyed out until the delay is armed and full. Hover for the reason: **Arm the delay first** or **Delay still building…**.

Disarm the delay

Press **DELAY** again. The stream goes back to no delay.

Good to know

- **No key starts, pauses or resumes a deck.** Only the board's **ON** does. **A** turns AUTO on or off; it does not play anything.
- **The delay is 8 seconds.** It is not adjustable in this version.
- **Every start is recorded.** The Health Monitor's live activity log shows each start, segue and stop with the song name.

5. Library

What it's for

The Library is every piece of audio your station owns: songs, spots, sweepers and announcements. You bring audio in here, give each song a category so it can be scheduled, fix its title and artist, set its cue points, and load it to a deck or the queue. Every file you import is copied into Ether's own audio folder, so the Library never depends on where the file happened to sit on your computer.

Where to find it

- **Library** → **Library** opens the Library as a full screen in the main window.
- **LIBRARY** in the bottom bar opens it docked under the decks, so the live screen stays in view. Drag the divider above it to make it taller or shorter.
- ☰ → **Library** opens it in its own window. (The cue editor items are not in this window. Use the main window's Library to edit cue points.)
- **File** → **Import Music…** and **Library** → **Import from Folder…** both open the Library screen. Then press **+ Import Music** (see below).

Plan: Local (every plan). The cloud music library at the end of this chapter needs **Live 128, Live 320 or Network**.

Import music

1. Open the Library and press **+ Import Music** (top right).
2. Under **Assign to Category**, pick the category the new songs belong to, or leave **No Category**. To make a new category here, type a **Code (e.g. XMAS)** and a **Name (e.g. Christmas)** and press **+ New**.
3. Press **Choose Folder & Import** to bring in a whole folder (sub-folders included), or **Choose File(s) & Import** to pick single files. Ether accepts MP3, FLAC, OGG, WAV, M4A, AAC and AIFF.
4. Ether first checks for songs you already have. A song counts as "already in your library" when it has the **same title and the same length** as one you own.
   - **Skip all … — import only the … new** leaves your songs as they are.
   - **Replace all …** keeps your songs (their category and play history) and swaps in the new files.
   - Or choose **Skip** or **Replace** song by song, then press **Continue**.
   - **Cancel import** goes back without importing anything.
5. When it finishes, **Import Complete** shows how many were imported, skipped and replaced. If any file could not be copied into the audio folder, it is listed under **NOT added**, and no entry was made for it.
6. Press **Done**.

Ether measures the loudness of each new song in the background after import.

Find a song

- **Search title or artist…** also matches cart numbers.
- The type chips (**Songs**, **Spots**, **Sweepers**, **Announcements**) narrow the list to one kind of audio. With none picked, you see everything.

- **UNMEASURED** (only shown when there are some) lists songs that have no loudness measurement yet. They play at the file's own level.
- **All Categories** shows one category at a time.
- Click a column heading to sort by it. Click again to reverse.
- ⚙ (at the right of the column headings) chooses which columns you see.

Give songs a category

A song with no category can never be scheduled. Its category box is outlined in amber and says **WON'T AIR**.

1. In the song's **Category** column, pick a category from the drop-down. It saves at once.
2. To make a new category from the Library, press **+ Category**, type a **Code** (up to 6 letters) and a **Name**, pick a colour and press **Create**.

Edit a song's details

- **Double-click** a cell in the **Artist**, **Album**, **Year**, **Genre** or **BPM** column, type, and press **Enter** (Esc cancels). If the save is refused, the cell stays open and says why.
- For the title and everything at once, **right-click** the song and choose **Edit Metadata**. Change **Title**, **Artist**, **Album**, **Year**, **Genre** or **BPM** and press **Save**.
- 🔍 **Lookup on Discogs** (in Edit Metadata) searches Discogs and fills artist, album, year and genre from the result you click. It needs your Discogs key, entered in **Settings → Integrations → Discogs Metadata**.
- **Right-click → Enter Cart #** gives the item a short number (for example 1001, J14, TALK7). Ether warns you if another item already has that number.

Play, queue and other actions

Each row has quick buttons:

- **A**, **B**, **C** load the song to that deck.
- **Q** adds it to the bottom of the queue.
- The **cue** button opens a small menu: **Open in Cue Editor** or **Quick Cue here** (a compact cue editor that slides up over the Library).
- ✕ deletes it (Ether asks first).

Queue All adds every song in the current view to the queue.

Tick the boxes at the left of rows to select several. With two or more selected, **Bulk assign metadata** appears. **Delete N** deletes the selected items (Ether asks first and reports how many went).

Right-click a row for more:

- **Mark as Sweeper** / **Unmark Sweeper (→ Music)** — moves it out of (or back into) music rotation as imaging.
- **Mark as Spot (SPOT)** — turns the track into a spot. A small window asks for a spot **Category** (pick one or type a new name) and a **Type** (Commercial, Promo, PSA, Sponsorship). The track leaves music rotation and appears in Spots & Promos (Chapter 8). **Unmark Spot (→ Music)** puts it back.

- **Load to Deck A / B / C**, **Add to Queue**.
- **Edit Cue Points** — opens the Cue Editor.
- **Measure loudness** / **Re-measure loudness** — measures the file and stores the result. The audio file itself is never changed.
- **Send to Studio** — opens the song in the Show+ DAW window.
- **Open File Location** — shows the file on disk.
- **Delete**.

Normalize

Normalize (in the row of buttons at the top of the Library) works out, for each song, how much it would need to be turned up or down to reach −14 LUFS, and stores that figure with the song. The audio file is not changed.

1. Press **Normalize**.
2. Ether takes up to 50 songs that don't have a figure yet and works through them. The status reads **Analyzing… N/50** as it goes.
3. When it finishes it says **Done! Analyzed N songs.** If every song already has a figure, it says **All songs already analyzed**.
4. If a song can't be analyzed (for example the file is missing or can't be read), Ether says so and leaves that song exactly as it was. No made-up figure is stored. The message reads **Analyzed X of N. K could not be analyzed and were left unchanged:** followed by the first few song titles. It stays on screen longer so you can read it.
5. Press **Normalize** again for the next 50.

The level a song plays at on air comes from its loudness measurement (see **UNMEASURED** and **Measure loudness** above), not from the Normalize figure.

Fix missing song lengths (Scan Durations)

A song with no length, or a length under one second, throws off clock timing. ⏱ **Scan Durations** reads each such file's real length.

1. Open the **CATEGORIES** editor (Chapter 6).
2. Press ⏱ **Scan Durations** (next to **+ New Category**). It reads **Scanning…** while it works.
3. The status beside it counts up: **Scanning… N/M (X fixed, Y failed)**.
4. When it finishes: ✓ **Done — X updated, Y failed**. A song counts as failed when its file can't be read; its length is left as it was. If every song already has a length, it says ✓ **All songs have duration data**.

Delete

Deleting takes the item out of the library and out of every future log. What already aired stays in your records. Ether always asks first; press **Delete** (or Enter) to confirm, **Cancel** (or Esc) to keep it.

Delete All removes every song in this station's library. Ether asks first. Use it with care.

Cue Editor

The Cue Editor sets where a song starts and ends on air, and where its intro and outro are.

Where to find it: right-click a song → **Edit Cue Points**, or the row's cue button → **Open in Cue Editor** / **Quick Cue here**. **Library** → **Cue Editor** and **Tools** → **Cue Editor** open it too: if no song is loaded in it, you see **Import Tracks**, where **Browse Files** or **Scan Folder** adds audio and **Edit cues** → opens a song.

Plan: Local (every plan).

1. Press play (or **Space**) to listen. The preview plays on the output chosen in the box at the top (**Default Output** unless you pick another). It does not go to air.
2. Click anywhere on the waveform to move the playhead there.
3. Drag the markers on the waveform to set:
   - **CUE IN** — where playback starts.
   - **INTRO END** — where the vocals come in (for talking over the intro).
   - **OUTRO START** — where the next item may start.
   - **CUE OUT** — where playback ends.
4. Or press **INTRO** or **OUTRO**, then drag across the waveform to paint that region.
5. Click one of the four boxes above the waveform to jump to that point. ▶ **FROM IN** plays from Cue In.
6. Zoom with the zoom buttons or Ctrl+scroll. Scroll to move along the song. **FIT** shows the whole track.
7. Press **Save Cue Points**. The button shows ✓ **Saved**.

Also in the top bar:

- **E** / 🔞 **EXPLICIT** marks the song explicit or clean (saved with **Save Cue Points**).
- **MB Lookup** looks the song up on MusicBrainz and marks it explicit or clean from what it finds (it saves straight away).
- **Reset** puts the four points back to the start and end of the file. Nothing is saved until you press **Save Cue Points**.

Clip Editor (video clips)

Where to find it: Tools → Clip Editor.

Plan: Local (every plan).

The Clip Editor records short video clips from your camera, sized for broadcast or social media.

1. Ether opens your camera. If it can't, it says **Camera unavailable**; press **Retry**.
2. Under **FORMAT** pick **16:9 Landscape**, **9:16 Vertical** or **1:1 Square**, or pick a phone or tablet under **DEVICE PRESETS**.
3. Press ● **Record**. Press **Stop** to finish.
4. Watch it back. 💾 **Save to Disk** saves it as a WebM video. ↩ **Back to Camera** returns to the camera. ✕ **Discard** throws the clip away.
5. 📂 **Open Video…** plays an existing video file in the same viewer.

Import Library (from another automation system)

Where to find it: Tools → Import Library...

Plan: Local (every plan).

This brings in a **song list** from WideOrbit, GSelector or Zetta (XML or CSV export).

1. Optionally pick the source system. Ether also detects it from the file.
2. Drop the XML or CSV file on the box, or click it to browse.
3. Check the field mapping table (**Source field**, **Sample value**, **Maps to**, **Status**).
4. Press **Start Import — N records**. Songs already in your library (same title and artist) are skipped. Categories named in the file are created if you don't have them.
5. **Import complete** shows what was imported and skipped. Press **Done**.

This imports the song **records only**: title, artist, length, category, rotation details. It does not bring in any audio. A song with no audio file cannot air.

Cloud music library

Where to find it: Settings → Backup & Restore → Keep my stuff synced, then open **Advanced**.

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network.

Your audio files can be kept in the cloud so every computer signed into your account has them.

- **Coming down is automatic.** While **Keep my stuff synced** is on, Ether checks for new audio on a timer and fetches only the files this computer doesn't have yet.
- **Going up is a button.** Audio you add on this computer goes up when you press **Send just the audio**. Nothing uploads on a timer. **Stop** cancels a send in progress. Tick **Re-send every file, even ones already uploaded** to send everything again.
- **Your audio files** says how many of your files are in the cloud and how many are still to send.
- **WHERE YOUR AUDIO LIVES** shows the folder Ether keeps your audio in. **Change folder** picks another.
- **Having trouble? Check connection** tests the link to the cloud.

Good to know

- Every import copies the file into Ether's audio folder and stores that copy. If a file can't be copied, Ether tells you which one and why, and makes no entry for it.
- A song is only scheduled if it has a category, has an audio file, and is marked as music (not a sweeper or spot).
- If the library is borrowed from another account, it is read-only: **+ Import Music** shows 🔒 **Borrowed (read-only)** and title/artist/album/year/genre/BPM can't be changed. You can still give songs categories and program them.
- Deleting a song never rewrites what already aired.

6. Categories, clocks and shows

What it's for

These three things decide what your station plays and when.

- A **category** is a group of songs that rotate together (for example A = power currents, D = gold).
- A **clock** is the recipe for one hour: which category plays in each position, where the spots go, where the talk breaks are.
- A **show** is a block of time on certain days (a daypart) with a clock assigned to it.

When you fill the log (Chapter 7), Ether walks through your shows hour by hour, follows each show's clock, and picks a song from each category position using your rotation rules.

Where to find it

- **Bottom bar: SHOWS**, **CLOCKS** and **CATEGORIES** each open that editor docked under the decks. Press the same button again to close it.
- **Schedule** → **Clocks**, **Schedule** → **Shows & Dayparts**, **Schedule** → **Categories** open the **Schedule** screen in the main window on that tab. It has all three tabs and a **+ Create Show** button.
- ☰ → **Shows**, ☰ → **Categories**, and ☰ → **Schedule** (clocks) open each editor in its own window.
- **Schedule** → **Schedule Manager** shows all three side by side (Chapter 7).
- **Rotation rules: Settings** → **Programming** → **Music Scheduling Rules**.

Plan: Local (every plan).

Categories

Make a category

1. Open **CATEGORIES** and press **+ New Category**.
2. Type a **Code** (for example A) and a **Name**.
3. Optionally enter **Spins/hr** (your target, see below) and pick a colour.
4. Press **Save**. It shows ✓ **Saved**.

Change a category

Press **Edit** on its row, change it, and press **Save**. **Cancel** closes without saving.

The list shows each category's colour, code, name, how many **Songs** are in it, and its **Spins/hr** target.

What Spins/hr does

Spins/hr is a target you declare: how many times an hour you want this category heard. It does not change which songs get picked. Rotation Analytics compares what actually aired against it, and the Health Monitor uses it to warn when a category has too few songs. Leaving it empty means "no target".

Put songs into a category

Songs get their category in the Library (Chapter 5): the category drop-down on each row, or **Assign to Category** while importing.

Clocks

Make a clock

1. Open **CLOCKS**.
2. Type a name in **New clock name…** and press **Create**. The new clock is selected.

SAVED CLOCKS on the left lists your clocks. Click one to open it. To delete one, press ✕ next to it, then **Yes** (or **No** to keep it). Deleting a clock also removes it from any show that used it.

Build the hour

The clock is a list of rows from the top of the hour down. Each row shows its **POSITION** (minutes and seconds past the hour), **TYPE**, **CATEGORY**, a sample **TITLE** and **ARTIST** from that category, and its **DURATION**. The bottom line says how full the hour is: **N min remaining**, ✓ **Hour complete**, or ⚠ **… over — remove segments**.

Add rows with **QUICK ADD** at the top:

- Click a **category code** to add a song row from that category. Its length is set to the average length of the songs in that category.
- **Spots** → pick a spot category (or **Any spot**) to add a spot row. One spot from that category airs there.
- **TALK** → pick a length (**:15**, **:30**, **1:00**, **1:30**, **2:00**, **3:00**) or type a **CUSTOM** length and press **Add**.

+ More Options opens the same choices step by step (**Song**, **Spots**, **Talk break**).

Change a row

- **Double-click** the TYPE or CATEGORY cell to change it. On a Spots row, pick which spot category airs there.
- **Click** a row to select it, then type a new length in its DURATION box and press **Enter**.
- **Drag** a row up or down to move it.
- 📌 pins the row to one exact item by its cart number: type the **Cart #** and press OK. That item then plays in that position every time. Leave the box blank to clear the pin.
- ⎘ duplicates the row. ✕ removes it.
- With a row selected, **Ctrl+C** copies it and **Ctrl+V** adds a copy at the end of the clock.

Changes save as you make them. They reach the air the next time the log is filled (**Fill Day** in the Program Log, Chapter 7).

Timed spot breaks

Below the clock is **Timed Spot Breaks**: spots at set minutes past the hour, with music filling around them.

1. Press **+ Add break**.

2. In **Min past hr**, type the minute (0–59). **:00** lands exactly at the top of the hour. Any other minute lands at the nearest song boundary; a song is never cut.
3. Pick the **Spot category** (the number in brackets is how many spots can air from it today) or **Any spot**.
4. In **Spots**, type how many spots play back to back (1–10).
5. ✕ removes a break. Changes save automatically (✓ **Saved** flashes).

If a break has nothing it can air, Ether says so under it: ⚠ **0 eligible spots — this break airs nothing**, with the reason.

Important: when a clock has any timed breaks, Ether uses only that clock's **song rows** plus the timed breaks. The clock's Spots rows and talk breaks are not placed, and 📌 pins are not used. If you want those, use a clock without timed breaks.

Spot categories (on the clock screen)

In the full Schedule screen and the CLOCKS editor, **Spot Categories** lists your spot categories. **Edit** renames or recolours one (**Save**). To add one, type in **New category...**, pick a colour and press **Add**. The same list is in Spots & Promos (Chapter 8).

Shows and dayparts

Make a show

1. Open **SHOWS** and press **+ New Show**.
2. Type the **Show name**.
3. Set when it **starts** and **ends**. Any minute works (a show ending at 1:30 automates until 1:30). An end of 00:00 means midnight.
4. Pick a colour and, if you like, a **Description**.
5. Click the **Days** it runs (blue = on).
6. Leave **Active** ticked.
7. Press **Save Show**.

Give a show its clock

In the show list, pick a clock in the show's **Clock** drop-down. It saves at once. **— none —** removes it.

The **24-Hour Timeline** at the top draws every show in its colour, so gaps and overlaps are easy to see.

Press **Edit** on a show's row to change it, then **Save Show**.

Create Show (step by step)

On the full Schedule screen, **+ Create Show** walks you through it:

1. **Name & Daypart** — name, start and end time, active days, colour.
2. **Format Clock** — pick an existing clock, or create a new one by name.
3. **Music Category** — you can create a new category here (code, name, colour).
4. **Review** — check it and press ✓ **Create Show**.

Rotation rules

Where: Settings → Programming → Music Scheduling Rules.

These rules decide how soon things can repeat, and how many songs in a row can come from one category. Ether checks every song it picks against everything around it in the log, including what already aired.

- **Same song plays again after** — minutes (or hours) before the exact same recording can play again.
- **Same artist plays again after** — minutes before the same artist can play again. An artist credit such as "A feat. B" or "A & B" counts for both artists.
- **Same title (different artist) after** — minutes before the same title can play again. Two songs only count as the same title when the title **and** the length (to the second) match.
- **Max songs in a row from same category** — how many songs from one category can follow each other.

For each rule:

1. Type the number.
2. For the three time rules, pick **min** or **hrs**. (The max-in-a-row rule counts **songs**.)
3. Press the **STRICT** / **SOFT** button to switch between the two (see below).
4. Use the switch at the right to turn the rule on or off (a rule that is off is dimmed).

Each change saves at once.

STRICT and SOFT

When Ether fills a music position, it looks for a song in that category that meets every rule that is on (then in the station's fallback category, if you named one). If none does:

1. **SOFT rules are relaxed first.** Ether picks from the songs that still meet every **STRICT** rule, and records with that log row which SOFT rule was bent.
2. **A STRICT rule is broken only as the last resort**, when no song can meet it. The position then gets the song in that category that has waited longest since it last played. This is recorded with the log row and listed in the Health Monitor.

A position is only **UNSCHEDULED** when its category has no playable songs at all.

While the log is playing, Ether also refuses a song that would break a **STRICT** rule against what has really aired. SOFT rules are only used when the log is filled.

Max songs in a row

When a position would make one song too many from the same category:

- **STRICT**: that position takes its song from the next different category in the clock instead. If there is no other category in the clock, or it has no song, the rule is broken as the last resort, recorded with the log row and in the Health Monitor.
- **SOFT**: the position keeps its category, and the log row records that the rule was broken.

Only songs count. Spots, talk breaks and other items between songs don't end a run. The count starts again each time the log is filled.

The box under the rules on the Settings page sums this up.

Good to know

- A song is only picked if it has a category, has an audio file, is marked as music, and is not set inactive.
- Clock changes, show changes and rule changes affect the log the next time it is filled. Rows that already aired never change.
- A talk-break row holds its time in the hour. No audio is placed for it.

7. The schedule and the Program Log

What it's for

The **Program Log** is the day's log your station actually airs from: every song, spot and break, hour by hour, with what already played, what is on air and what is coming. You build it with **Fill Day** or **Fill Week**, which follow your shows, clocks, categories and rotation rules (Chapter 6). You can then change any hour by hand.

The **Schedule Manager** puts shows, clocks, categories, spots, sweepers, the Program Log and the analytics on one screen. **Rotation Analytics** shows what actually aired against your targets.

Where to find it

- **Program Log**
  - **PROGRAM LOG** in the bottom bar docks it under the decks (the live screen stays in view).
  - **Schedule** → **Program Log** or ☰ → **Program Log** opens it in its own window.
  - You can have both open. They show the same rows and update each other within about a second.
- **Schedule Manager: Schedule** → **Schedule Manager** or ☰ → **Schedule Manager**.
- **Rotation Analytics: Schedule** → **Rotation Analytics** or ☰ → **Rotation Analytics**.

Plan: Local (every plan), except the **PDF Report** export (see "Export the log").

Read the day

1. Pick a day on the small calendar at the left (‹ and › change the month). A dot under a day means it already has a log.
2. **TODAY'S SHOWS** lists the day's shows. Click one to show only its hours; click it again to show all.
3. The day header reads **N of M hours scheduled · total programming**.
4. Each hour is a row: the show, the clock, how many items and how long they run. A green dot means the hour is filled; red means it has an empty position. Click the row to open or close it. **Expand All** and **Collapse All** do every hour.
5. Inside an hour, each item shows **Time**, **Type**, **Title**, **Artist**, **Duration** and **Status**.
   - **Time** is the scheduled time. Once the item has aired, the actual air time appears under it in green.
   - **Status** is **pending** (not yet), **playing** (on air now), **played**, or **didn't play**.
6. **Click a song** to see **Why this song**: its category, how many songs were in the pool, which rules ruled others out, and whether a rule had to be bent. Click again to hide it.

Fill Day and Fill Week

⚡ **Fill Day** builds the log for the selected day from your shows and clocks.

- It never changes anything that played, is playing, or was marked didn't play.
- An hour that has already started playing is never touched.
- Items you placed or changed by hand (marked **YOURS** in the hour editor) are kept.
- If the day has fully aired, it says **Nothing to fill — the day has aired**.

- When it finishes, the message says how many rows it built, how many positions got the least recently played song because nothing passed your rules, and how many are **UNSCHEDULED** (their category has no playable songs).

⚡ **Fill Week** does the same for the selected day **and the six days after it**, in one run. To plan further ahead, pick a later start day and press Fill Week again. There is no limit on how far ahead.

While either one runs, a progress bar shows how far it has got. **CANCEL** stops it at the next hour boundary. Every day that already finished is kept; you never get half a day.

Fill Day and Fill Week act on the station you are switched into.

Each show's log is also built automatically before the show starts, so there is always music inside a show even if nobody pressed Fill Day.

Clear

- **Clear Day** removes everything that hasn't aired yet, from the next hour on. Played, playing and didn't-play rows stay.
- The ✕ on an hour row clears that one hour. It only appears on hours that haven't started.

To rebuild part of a day, clear the hours you want rebuilt and press **Fill Day**. It fills the gaps and leaves the rest in place.

Edit an hour

1. Press ✎ **Edit** on a filled hour. The hour editor opens.
2. **Swap a song:** click a song. A list of songs from the same category appears; type in **Search songs…** to narrow it, then click the song you want.
3. **Swap two times:** drag a row onto another row. The two trade places.
4. **Remove a row:** press ✕ on it. The position refills on the next Fill Day.
5. Close the editor with ✕ at the top right.

Anything you place, move or swap is marked **YOURS**. Fill Day and Fill Week will not move, replace or remove it.

If an edit bends one of your rotation rules, a short amber note under the row says which. It informs; it does not block.

Rows that already aired can't be changed. Clicking one says **Already aired — a record, not a plan**. If Ether refuses an edit for any other reason, the reason appears in red at the top of the editor.

Export the log

- ⬇ **CSV** saves the day as a spreadsheet file.
- 🖶 **Print** opens a printable log and the print dialog.
- 📄 **PDF Report** builds a traffic report (station name, day totals, every hour) and opens the print dialog, where you can save it as a PDF. **Plan:** (not in the price list).

Shows & Dayparts (from the Program Log)

⚙ **Shows & Dayparts** in the day header opens a list of your shows where you can set each show's **Format Clock**.

To delete a show here, press the ✕ at the right of its row. It is deleted straight away (Ether does not ask first) and disappears from the list and the timeline.

For everything else about shows, use the Shows editor (Chapter 6).

Schedule Manager

The Schedule Manager is one screen made of panes: **Shows**, **Clocks**, **Categories**, **Spots**, **Sweepers**, **Rotation Analytics**, **Program Log** and **Play Log**. Each pane is the same editor you get elsewhere, so everything in Chapters 6, 7 and 8 works the same here.

1. The header shows how many shows, clocks and categories this station has.
2. **Drag** a pane by its tab to move it, stack it with others, or dock it beside another. Drag the edges between panes to resize them.
3. Close a pane with its ✕. **Panels** brings it back; when panes are closed it reads **Panels (N hidden)**.
4. Under **Layouts** in the Panels menu, pick a ready arrangement:
   - **Programming** — build the hour: shows, clocks, and the categories they draw from.
   - **Traffic** — spot work: spot categories and the breaks that place them.
   - **Analysis** — what actually aired, next to the targets and clocks that asked for it.
   - **Live** — today's log beside the shows that built it.
5. **Reset layout** returns to the Programming arrangement.
6. **Fixed layout** switches to a simpler three-pane screen. **Rotation Analytics** → opens Rotation Analytics.

Clicking a show selects its clock in the Clocks pane. Clicking a category outlines (in amber) every clock that uses it.

Rotation Analytics

Rotation Analytics reports what actually aired. It changes nothing.

1. Pick **24 Hours**, **7 Days** or **30 Days**. **Refresh** reads it again.
2. **Spins per hour — actual vs target** — each category's spins per hour against its **Spins/hr** target. A category with no target shows **—**.
3. **Hourly grid** — spins per category per hour.
4. **Artist burn** — the closest two airings of each artist, compared with your artist rule. **INSIDE RULE** marks an artist that played closer than your rule allows.
5. **Turnover** — how much of each category's eligible songs actually aired. Spins per song near 1.0 is even rotation.
6. **Why was this picked?** — how many aired rows carry a recorded reason. **Program Log** → opens the Program Log, where clicking a song shows its reason.

Each table has **Export CSV**. Column headings sort; column widths are remembered.

Good to know

- The Program Log is the same log the station plays from. What you see is what airs.
- What aired is a record. Nothing in this chapter can change a played row.
- A reason is only recorded when a row is built. Rows built before reasons were kept say so; a reason is never made up afterwards.
- A timed break whose minute the clock's songs never reach is not placed. It is reported to the Health Monitor so you can fix the clock.

8. Spots and promos

What it's for

Spots & Promos is where your commercials, promos and PSAs live, with their advertiser, dates, daily limit and category. Your clocks then say where spots go in each hour, and Fill Day picks which spot airs in each break, rotating them so the one that has waited longest goes next.

Where to find it

- **SPOTS** in the bottom bar.
- **Library** → **Spots & Promos**.
- The **Spots** pane in the **Schedule Manager** (Chapter 7).

Where spots air is set on the clock: **CLOCKS** → **Timed Spot Breaks**, or a **Spots** row in the clock (Chapter 6).

Plan: Local (every plan).

Add spots

At the top of Spots & Promos:

1. **Add Files** — pick one or more audio files (MP3, FLAC, OGG, WAV, M4A, AAC).
2. **Import Folder** — pick a folder; every audio file in it is added (sub-folders are not searched).

Each file is copied into Ether's audio folder and becomes a spot named after the file, with its real length read from the file. A file that is already a spot is skipped, and the message says how many.

You can also turn a track that is already in the Library into a spot: in the Library, **right-click** → **Mark as Spot (SPOT)**, pick a category and a type, and confirm (Chapter 5).

Import Traffic CSV

Import Traffic CSV reads a CSV or TSV export from a traffic system. Ether finds the columns by their headings: title, ISCI or cart number, advertiser, agency, length, start date, end date and type. A row that matches an existing spot (same ISCI, or same title and advertiser) updates that spot's dates and agency and switches it back to active; other rows become new spots.

This brings in the spot **records**, not audio. A spot with no audio file is never placed in the log and is marked ⚠ **WON'T AIR**. To give it audio, open it with **Edit** and press **Attach audio…** (see "Edit a spot").

Spot categories

A spot category groups spots so a break can pull from it (for example "Weekday Sponsors" or "PSAs").

1. Under **Spot Categories**, type a name in **New category name…**, pick a colour, and press **Add Category** (or Enter).
2. **Edit** renames or recolours a category; press **Save**.

The category list at the top (**Category: All / … / Uncategorized**) filters the spot list. The number after each name is how many spots are in it.

Edit a spot

1. Press **Edit** on the spot's row.
2. Set:
   - **Title** and type (**promo**, **psa**, **jingle**, **liner**, **sweeper**, **commercial**, **imaging**).
   - **Audio** — the name of the spot's audio file. A spot with none reads **No audio — this spot can't air until you attach its audio**. Press **Attach audio…** (or **Replace audio…** when it already has one) and pick an audio file (MP3, FLAC, OGG, WAV, M4A, AAC). Ether copies it into its audio folder, reads its real length, and saves it to the spot straight away; the message says **Audio attached to "…"**.
   - **Spot category** — the category a break pulls it from. **— No category (won't be pulled by a timed break) —** means no break will pull it, including **Any spot** breaks.
   - **Advertiser**.
   - The two date boxes beside Advertiser are the **start** and **end date** — the spot only airs between these dates. Leave them empty for no limit.
   - **Cart #** and **ISCI**.
   - **Max plays/day** — the most times Fill Day places it in one day.
   - **Active** — switch it off to take the spot off the air.
   - **Notes**.
   - **Artwork** — **Choose image…** picks a picture shown as this spot's artwork while it plays, instead of whatever artwork the file carries. **Clear** removes it.
3. Press **Save**. **Cancel** closes without saving.

Switching a spot to inactive takes it out of every future log. The message says how many future airings were pulled.

The spot list

- The type chips (**All**, **promo**, **commercial**, …) filter by type.
- The counters show **Total Spots**, **Active** and **Total Plays**.
- Each row shows **Title**, **Type**, **Category**, **Advertiser**, **Plays** and **Active**.
- ⚠ **WON'T AIR** marks a spot that is inactive, has no category, or has no audio. Hover over it to see which. No break ever picks a spot marked WON'T AIR, including **Any spot** breaks and rows.
- ▶ **Play** loads the spot on **Deck B and starts it at once**. That is on air. Use it only when you mean to play the spot now.
- **Q** adds the spot to the bottom of the queue.
- **Edit** opens the editor.

Put spots in the hour

There are two ways, both on the clock (Chapter 6):

- **Timed Spot Breaks** — "at :20, play 3 spots from Weekday Sponsors". The break lands at the nearest song boundary to that minute (a song is never cut); **:00** lands exactly at the top of the hour.
- **A Spots row** in the clock — one spot from the chosen spot category plays in that position.

A clock that has timed breaks uses only the timed breaks for spots; its Spots rows are not placed.

Any spot (on a break or a row) means any active spot in any of your spot categories. A spot with no category is not included.

Which spot airs

Each time a break needs a spot, Fill Day picks from the spots that are:

- active,
- in that category (or in any category, for **Any spot** — a spot with no category is never picked),
- inside their start and end dates,
- holding an audio file,
- under their **Max plays/day** for that day,

and takes the one that has waited longest since it last aired.

When a break would air nothing

If a timed break on this station's active clock has no spot it can air, Spots & Promos shows a warning at the top: ⚠ **N spot breaks on this station's active clock will air NOTHING**, listing each break's minute and category and what to do (add or activate a spot in that category, or re-pick the category on the clock). The clock screen shows the same warning under the break (⚠ **0 eligible spots — this break airs nothing**).

Good to know

- Spots, sweepers and announcements never enter music rotation.
- Changes to spots and clocks reach the air the next time the log is filled (Fill Day / Fill Week, Chapter 7). Making a spot inactive pulls it from the future log at once.
- A spot's play count goes up each time it airs.

9. Imaging: sweepers and carts

What it's for

Imaging is the short produced audio that sounds like your station: legal IDs, stingers, "you're listening to..." drops, sound effects and beds. Ether handles it two ways:

- **Sweepers** are scheduled. You say which music categories get one, and Ether places a sweeper ahead of every song in those categories. The sweeper plays over the end of the song before and into the start of the song it introduces. Nothing stops and nothing skips. (Older versions of Ether called some of these "jingles". There is now one kind of scheduled imaging, and it is called a sweeper.)
- **Carts** are fired by hand. A cart wall is a grid of buttons; each button holds one piece of audio and plays it when you press it.

Where to find it

- **Bottom bar** → **SWEEPERS** (next to CATEGORIES): the place where sweepers are set up. It has two tabs: **MANAGE** and **ADD IMAGING — CUT A REEL**.
- **☰ menu** → **Imaging**, or **Tools** → **Monitors** → **Imaging**: the IMAGING window, which shows all of your imaging in one place. You can also reach it from the SWEEPERS panel with **OPEN IMAGING** →.
- **Bottom bar** → **CARTS**: the cart wall, pushed up under the decks.
- **☰ menu** → **Carts**: the cart wall in its own window.

Plan: Local (every plan).

Sweepers

Step 1. Mark your imaging as sweepers

1. Open the **Library**.
2. Right-click a cut and choose **Mark as Sweeper**.
3. The cut now appears in the SWEEPERS panel and in the IMAGING window.

To undo it, right-click the cut again and choose **Unmark Sweeper (→ Music)**.

If your imaging arrived as one long reel, cut it up first: see **Cutting a reel into sweepers** below.

Step 2. Build pools (recommended)

A pool is a group of sweepers that take turns. Ether plays the one that has gone longest without playing, so the same cut does not repeat too soon.

1. Open **SWEEPERS** → **MANAGE**.
2. Type a name in **New sweeper pool (e.g. Legal IDs)** and press **Add pool** (or Enter).
3. Click the pool's name in the list. The panel shows **In *pool name*** with the cuts already in it.
4. Under **Add a cut**, type part of a cut's name in the search box. Click a result (marked **+**) to add it.
5. To take a cut out of the pool, press ✕ beside it. The cut stays in the Library and in any other pool.
6. To rename a pool, click its name, type, and click away.

7. To delete a pool, press ✕ at the end of its row and confirm. Categories that used it are left with no sweeper; the cuts themselves are not deleted.

Good to know about pools:

- A cut can be in several pools at once. Adding it to one pool takes it out of nothing.
- Every sweeper in the Library is available to every station. Pools are per station.
- Cuts of different lengths can share a pool.
- You can rename a cut from inside the pool: press **EDIT** beside its name. The new name shows everywhere, including the Library.

Step 3. Assign sweepers to categories

This is what decides where sweepers play. Under **Category assignments**, each music category has one row:

Column	What it does
OVERLAY	**— none (no sweeper) —**, one **Specific sweeper**, or a **Sweeper pool (rotates)**.
LEAD (s)	How many seconds before the song starts its sweeper begins.
ACTIVE HOURS	**Always**, or untick it and pick a first and last hour.

1. In **OVERLAY**, pick a sweeper or a pool for each category that should get imaging. Leave **— none (no sweeper) —** on categories that should not.
2. In **LEAD (s)**, type a number of seconds and press Enter (or click away). A grey number is the station default (2 seconds), shown so you can see what is airing. Clear the box to go back to the default.
3. In **ACTIVE HOURS**, untick **Always** to limit imaging to certain hours, then pick the hours.

Every change is saved straight away and applied to the log ahead at once. You do not need to fill the day again. A line under the assignments says what happened, for example *"KIDS: sweeper saved. Log ahead updated: 212 sweepers placed (198 replaced)."* If something could not be saved, the line is red and says why.

None means none. A category set to none never gets a sweeper. That is a normal programming choice, not an error.

Step 4 (optional). AUTO-POST

Under the assignments there is one switch for the whole station: **AUTO-POST OFF / ON**.

- **OFF** (the default): sweepers start LEAD seconds before the next song.
- **ON**: a sweeper from a pool is timed to end exactly where the next song's vocal starts (the intro marker set in the Cue Editor). Ether picks a cut from the pool that is short enough.
  - A song with no intro marker uses LEAD instead.
  - A category assigned a single specific sweeper uses LEAD.
  - If no cut in the pool is short enough, that seam gets no sweeper.

To mark a song's intro: right-click the song → **Open in Cue Editor** → **INTRO END**.

Cutting a reel into sweepers (ADD IMAGING — CUT A REEL)

Use this when your imaging arrives as one long file with many cuts separated by silence. It also works for a single cut you want to import and tag in one go.

1. Open **SWEEPERS** → **ADD IMAGING — CUT A REEL**.
2. Drag the file onto the box that says **Drop a reel — or a single cut — here**, or press **Open reel…**.
3. Ether finds the silent gaps and splits the reel into numbered regions on the waveform.
4. Too many or too few regions? Move the **Silence threshold** slider (−70 to −25 dB) and press **Re-cut**. A lower (more negative) number splits on quieter gaps.
5. Check each region:
   - **Space** plays the selected region; press again to stop.
   - ← / → move between regions.
   - **Delete** removes the selected region.
   - Drag the left or right edge of the selected region on the waveform to adjust it.
   - Row buttons: ▶ play · ⫧ split in half · ⩒ merge with the next · ✕ delete.
6. Each region is named after the reel with a number (for example *legal ids 01*). Press **EDIT** on a name to change it.
7. Optionally pick a **Pool**.
8. Press **Commit N sweepers** →. Each region is saved as its own file, added to the Library as a sweeper, and put in the pool you picked.

When it finishes it says ✓ **N of N committed to Library**. If one cut fails, it says which one and how many were already added; those are really in the Library.

The IMAGING window

☰ **menu** → **Imaging** opens one window with five tabs:

- **RACK**: every imaging cut in the Library, with its **Type**, **Length** and the station's **Pools** it is in. It shows the first 300 and says so if there are more.
- **POOLS**: the same pool editor as in the SWEEPERS panel. Changes made here are real and saved.
- **ASSIGNMENTS**: the same category assignments as in the SWEEPERS panel, also live.
- **ON DECK**: the next sweepers in the log, each with its time, the cut, and the song it introduces. If nothing is placed it tells you why: no log ahead, no category assigned, or the placements fall outside the active hours. This tab only shows; it does not change the log.

Carts

Open the cart wall

- **Bottom bar** → **CARTS** pushes the wall up under the decks: 8 square buttons across, 3 rows visible, scroll for more (64 in all).
- ☰ **menu** → **Carts** opens the Carts window: six big buttons at a time (2 across, 3 down) and five more blocks of six below, reached by scrolling (36 in all).

If one of your deck slots is set up as a cart wall, the CARTS button in the bottom bar is dimmed and does not open (so you don't get two walls). Hover it to see why. Change that slot in **DECKS** to use the push-up instead.

Put audio on a button

1. Click a button that says **Empty**, and pick an audio file. Or drag a file onto a button.
2. The file is copied into your audio library first, and the button is named after the file.

Rename, replace or clear a button

Right-click a loaded button:

- **RENAME…**: type a new name, press Enter (Escape cancels). Double-clicking a button does the same.
- **REPLACE FILE…**: pick a different file for this button.
- **OPEN FILE LOCATION**: shows the file in its folder (greyed if the file is not on this computer).
- **DELETE**: empties the button. The file stays in your library.

Fire a cart

1. Click a loaded button. It flashes and counts down while it plays.
2. Click it again to stop it.
3. Keyboard: the first 24 buttons have keys — **1–8**, **Q–I** and **A–K**. Press the key on its own; with Ctrl, Alt or Cmd held, nothing fires.

The slider beside the meter is the **cart level**.

Good to know

- **Where carts are heard.** A cart plays on every board channel whose input is set to **Cart / SFX rack**. If no channel is, it plays on the built-in cart channel instead. If you press a cart and hear nothing, check that channel's fader and ON first.
- Carts are saved per station. Each station has its own wall.
- Sweepers are placed on the songs in the log. With no log ahead there is nothing to place them on — fill the day first.
- **LEAD limits:** the box will not go above 90 seconds minus your segue overlap (hover the box to see the exact maximum). A LEAD under about 1 second can be missed.
- Sweepers already aired, and sweepers you placed by hand, are never moved when you change an assignment. A sweeper already loaded for the very next seam may still play.
- With more than one cart wall in a window, the keys belong to the wall you last clicked.
- **Plan:** carts, sweeper pools and assignments are saved with the station. Having them appear on your other computers uses Multi-computer sync, which needs **Live 128, Live 320 or Network**.

10. Voice Tracker

What it's for

The Voice Tracker lets a jock record talk breaks ahead of time and drop each one into the log between two songs, so it airs at that spot as if the jock were live. You see the song before and the song after while you talk, record, trim the take, and place it.

Where to find it

- ☰ → **Voice Tracker**: opens it in its own window.
- **Library** → **Voice Tracker**, or **Tools** → **Voice Tracker**: opens it in the main window.
- **Tools** → **Monitors** → **Voice Tracker**: opens it in its own window.
- The small pop-out arrow in the Voice Tracker's top bar also opens it in its own window.

Plan: Local (every plan).

Before you start

Pick your voice-tracking microphone (once)

1. Open **Settings** → **Audio Devices**.
2. Under **Voice-tracking microphone**, click the mic you record voice tracks with. It shows **ACTIVE**.
3. That choice is saved on this computer. The Voice Tracker records from it, in the main window and in its own window.

The on-air mic is set separately, in **Mic Inputs** on the same page. If you never pick a voice-tracking mic, the Voice Tracker records from the computer's default microphone.

Fill the hour first

The Voice Tracker works from the log. The hour you want to track must already be filled. If it is not, the HOUR LOG says **No log for *hour*** — fill the day first (Program Log → Fill Day).

Record a talk break

1. **Pick the hour.** Use the hour box at the top left. Each hour shows the show that runs then, if there is one. The log shown is the next time that hour comes round (today, or tomorrow if the hour has passed).
2. **Type your name and a title** in the **DJ** and **Break title…** boxes at the top (both optional; with no title the break is named after the hour and the time you saved it).
3. **Pick the spot.** In the **HOUR LOG** on the right, every pair of songs has a **talk break** line between them. Click the one you want. It turns to ▸ **TALK BREAK**, and the screen shows the song before (**prev**) at the top and the song after (**next**) at the bottom.
4. **Record.** Press ● **REC** or the **Space** bar. The waveform builds as you talk and the meter shows your level.
5. **Stop.** Press ■ or **Space** again. The take opens in the editor. It is not saved yet.

The length box beside each talk break (**—:—**, **0:05** … **2:00**) is for planning: it adds that time to the **HOUR FILL** meter on the right so you can see how full the hour will be. It does not cut or limit your recording.

Trim and tidy the take

The take is shown as a waveform with a playhead.

To do this	Do this
Play / stop	**Space**, or the play button
Move the playhead	Click the waveform; ← / → (0.1 s), **Shift** + ←/→ (1 s)
Select a part	Drag across the waveform, or press **[** at the start and **]** at the end. **M** twice also marks a selection.
Clear the selection	**K**
Delete the selection	**Delete** or **Backspace**
Cut / copy / paste	**Ctrl+X** / **Ctrl+C** / **Ctrl+V** (pastes at the playhead)
Select all	**Ctrl+A**
Undo / redo	**Ctrl+Z** / **Ctrl+Y** (or **Ctrl+Shift+Z**), or the buttons
Fade in / fade out the selection	the two fade buttons
Add half a second of silence at the playhead	**SIL**
Zoom	**Q** (×1 → ×4 → ×10); drag the bar under the waveform to move around

Place it on air

1. With a talk break picked in the HOUR LOG, press **+ BREAK**.
2. The take is saved as an audio file in your audio library, added to your recorded breaks, and put into the log just before the next song.
3. The talk-break line turns green and says **VOICE TRACK PLACED**.

If the take was saved but could not be placed (for example, the next song is no longer in the upcoming log), a message says so. The take is still in your recorded breaks.

+ BREAK is greyed until you pick a talk break.

Other things you can do with a finished take:

- **A**, **B**, **C**: load the take onto that deck. It is saved to your audio library first and appears on the deck as **[VT]** followed by the break title. It is loaded, not started. If the deck refuses it, a message says **Failed to send:** with the reason, and the take stays in the editor.
- **Q**: add it to the end of the play queue now instead of placing it in the log.
- ✕: throw the take away.

Your recorded breaks

At the bottom of the right column, **RECORDED (*n*)** opens the list of your breaks (the latest 100).

- Press a break's play button to hear it on this computer only. Press it again to stop.
- **Q** adds it to the play queue.
- ✕ deletes it (you are asked first). If the break had been placed in the log, deleting it also takes it out of the log ahead.

The ▶ button in the transport (next to ● **REC**) plays your most recent break.

Good to know

- The Voice Tracker records from the voice-tracking microphone picked in Settings. If that mic isn't connected, it records from the computer's default microphone and says so next to REC: *The voice-tracking mic picked in Settings isn't connected — recording from the default mic.*
- If it cannot open a microphone at all (for example Windows refuses Ether access), it says *Could not access microphone. Check Settings → Audio Devices.* It does not switch to another mic.
- Playing a take or a break in the Voice Tracker is only heard on this computer. It does not go to air.
- A take is placed by the next song's title. If that song is removed from the log or replaced before air, the take may not land where you meant — check the log after big changes.
- The hour box and the name boxes are locked while you are recording.

11. Announcements and the EAS Logbook

What it's for

Announcements play recorded messages at set times on calendar dates — "the park closes in 30 minutes", "the parade starts at 7", a legal notice. The programme ducks under the announcement and comes back, even in the middle of a song.

The **EAS Logbook** is your Emergency Alert System record: every required weekly and monthly test and every real alert your station received or sent, with a compliance summary and printouts for an inspector. Ether keeps the log; it does not generate EAS tones (that is your encoder/decoder's job).

Where to find it

- **Schedule** → **Announcements**, or ☰ **menu** → **Announcements**.
- **Schedule** → **EAS Logbook**, or ☰ **menu** → **EAS Logbook**. Both open it in its own window.

Plan: Local (every plan).

Announcements

Before anything can air: patch an Announcement channel

An announcement plays on a board channel whose input is set to **Announcement**. If there is none, the top of the page says so in amber, and the ▶ **AIR** buttons are greyed.

1. On the board, press **+** and choose **Announcement**.
2. Turn **DUCK ON** for that channel so the programme steps back while it plays.

How far the programme ducks, and for how long, is set per station in **Settings** → **Ducker**. There is no per-announcement duck setting.

Add an announcement (the audio)

An announcement is just a name and an audio file. When it plays is set separately, on the calendar.

1. Press **+ Add Announcement** (top right).
2. Pick the audio file. It is copied into your audio library.
3. Check the **Title** and press **Save**.

In the list at the bottom of the page each announcement shows:

- **Scheduled**: the next date it plays and when. **not scheduled** (amber) means it will never fire — the first thing to check if something didn't go to air.
- **Status**: **ON** / **OFF**. Click to switch. An announcement that is OFF does not fire.
- ▶ **AIR**: play it on air now, on the Announcement channel.
- ▶ **Test**: hear it on this computer only. It does not go to air.
- **Edit**: change the title.

- ✕: delete it. Ether asks first in its own confirm window, and tells you how many schedule lines go with it. Press **OK** to delete, **Cancel** (or Esc) to keep it.

Schedule it: Select → Edit → Apply

Scheduling works on real calendar dates. There is no "every Wednesday": you pick the actual dates. **Nothing is written until you press APPLY.**

One date:

1. Click the date in the **Dates** calendar. The **Schedule** column loads what is on that day.
2. Change what you want (see *Building the list* below).
3. Press **APPLY to 1 date**. Only that day changes, and the panel clears.

Several dates at once:

1. Click each date you want. The first click loads that date's list; later clicks just add dates to the selection.
   - Click a weekday letter at the top of the calendar to select every one of those days in the month shown.
   - Use ‹ and › to change month. The selection stays as you move between months.
   - **Clear *n*** removes the whole selection.
2. Build the list.
3. Press **APPLY to *n* dates**. Every selected date gets exactly that list.

Copy one day to others: click the day to copy (it loads), click the other dates, then press Apply.

Building the list

Press **+ Add Announcement** in the Schedule column to add a line. On each line:

1. Pick the announcement.
2. Pick how it is timed:
   - **at a set time**: type the time.
   - **before closing**: type the minutes (and, if you want, seconds) before closing. A negative number is before closing; 0 is closing time itself.
3. Pick how many times it plays in a row (**×1** to **×10**). Each repeat starts when the one before ends.
4. The time at the end of the line is when it will actually fire. **no time** (red) means it cannot play yet.
5. ✕ removes the line.

If any line is timed from closing, a box appears above the list: **This date closes at** (or **These *n* dates close at**). Set the closing time there. It is saved with the lines when you press Apply, for the selected dates only. If no closing time is set, the panel says the closing-time lines cannot play.

If the same announcement is on the list twice, the panel warns you that it will play more than once.

What Apply does

- Apply makes each selected date's list **exactly** what is in the editor. Anything on those dates that is not in the editor is removed.
- If any selected date already has announcements, you are asked to confirm with **Replace** or **Cancel**.
- Applying an empty list clears those dates. The panel warns you first.

- **unapplied changes** (amber) next to the button means you have edited but not applied. **Cancel** throws the edits away.
- A date on the calendar showing **♪3** has three announcements on it.

TONIGHT: did it play?

At the top of the page, **TONIGHT** lists today's announcements in the order they play.

- While one is on air, its line pulses red with **ON AIR** and the seconds left.
- Afterwards it says **Played *time*** (green).
- **Failed *time*: reason** (red): Ether tried to play it and could not; the reason says why.
- **Skipped *time*** (amber): the closing time moved and its time had already passed.
- **Did not play** (red): its time has passed (plus the late limit) and nothing says it played.
- **No time — no closing time set, so it will not play** (amber).
- **Up next** / **Waiting** / **Due now**: not played yet.

Late limit. At the top of TONIGHT: *Late limit: a line may still start up to [ ] seconds after its time.* If Ether is busy at the exact second, a line may still start within this many seconds. Type whole seconds (0 to 3600) and press **Save**. Leave it empty and press Save to clear it: lines then fire only on their own second.

EAS Logbook

The summary

Four cards at the top show how you stand:

- **RWT this week**: target 1 (green when met).
- **RMT this month**: target 1.
- **Days since RWT**: should be under 7 (red above 7).
- **Days since RMT**: should be under 31 (red above 31).

The cards count the entries shown, so use **This month** or wider to see the full picture.

Log an entry

1. Press **+ Log Entry**.
2. Fill in:
   - **Date / Time of event** — a new entry starts at the current local time on this computer.
   - **Alert code**: RWT, RMT, NPT, EAN, EAT, TOR, SVR, FFW, WSW, AVA, HUW, ADR or CAE.
   - **Direction**: Received, Transmitted, or Both (received + retransmitted).
   - **Originator**: PEP, EAS, WXR, CIV or EAN.
   - **Sender / Source ID** (e.g. WXYZ)
   - **Received from** (your monitoring assignment, e.g. LP-1)
   - **Retransmitted** tick box, and **Retransmitted at** if ticked.
   - **Operator initials**
   - **Notes** (optional)
3. Press **Log entry**.

View, edit and delete

- Choose **This week**, **This month**, **Past year** or **All time** to filter the list.
- **Edit** opens an entry; press **Update** to save.
- **Del** deletes an entry. Ether asks first in its own confirm window, with a reminder that the FCC requires two years of records — only delete duplicates or mistakes. Press **OK** to delete, **Cancel** (or Esc) to keep it.

Print or export

- **CSV**: downloads the entries shown as a spreadsheet file.
- **Print / PDF**: opens a printable page with the summary and the entries shown, and opens the print dialog. Choose "Save as PDF" there to make a PDF.

Good to know

- **Whether anyone hears an announcement is the board's call.** The schedule decides *when* it fires onto the Announcement channel. That channel's fader and ON decide whether it reaches air. If a scheduled announcement didn't go out, check the channel before the schedule.
- Each date owns its own list. After applying to five dates, each can be edited on its own.
- Announcements are scheduled per station. Having the schedule appear on your other computers uses Multi-computer sync (**Live 128, Live 320 or Network**).
- The EAS Logbook is kept on this computer, per station. It is not copied to your other computers.
- **EAS times** are shown and saved in this computer's local time. **Edit** shows an entry's **Date / Time of event** and **Retransmitted at** exactly as they were logged, so saving with **Update** does not move them.

12. Phone Desk

What it's for

The Phone Desk records a phone call (or any other input) so you can trim it into a clean clip and put it on a deck to air — a listener call, a contest winner, a quick interview.

Where to find it

- **Bottom bar** → **PHONE**: opens the Phone Desk under the decks.
- **☰ menu** → **Phone**, or **Tools** → **Monitors** → **Phone Desk**: opens it in its own window.
- The pop-out button in the Phone Desk's top bar also opens it in its own window.

Plan: Local (every plan).

Choose the input

Under **INPUT SOURCE**, pick one:

- **Audio Interface**: pick the input your phone hybrid or interface is on from the **DEVICE** list. The choice is remembered on this computer.
- **Softphone / SIP**: records your computer's default microphone input. If you take calls on a softphone, route its audio to a virtual audio device and choose that as the input, or set it as the default input.

Listen before you record

Press ▶ **MONITOR** to hear the input in your own headphones. It does not go to air. Press it again (it reads ● **MONITORING**) to stop.

Record the call

1. Press **RECORD**. It shows **STARTING…** for half a second, then starts.
2. While recording, the waveform builds across the screen, the meter shows the level, and the running time shows beside the button.
3. Press **STOP** when the call is done.

The recording opens in the editor. Pressing **RE-RECORD** later starts a new recording and replaces the current one.

Trim and edit the clip

Click the waveform first so the editor has the keyboard.

To do this	Do this
Play / stop	**Space**, or the play button
Move the playhead	Click the waveform; ← / → (0.1 s), **Shift +** ←**/**→ (1 s)
Select a part	Drag across the waveform, or **[** at the start and **]** at the end. **M** twice also marks a selection.
Clear the selection	**K**
Delete the selection	**Delete** or **Backspace**
Cut / copy / paste	**Ctrl+X** / **Ctrl+C** / **Ctrl+V** (pastes at the playhead)
Select all	**Ctrl+A**
Undo / redo	**Ctrl+Z** / **Ctrl+Y**, or the buttons
Fade in / fade out the selection	the two fade buttons
Add half a second of silence at the playhead	**SIL**
Zoom	**Q**

Send it to a deck

1. Press **A**, **B** or **C** in the editor's bar.
2. The edited clip is saved as an audio file and loaded onto that deck, titled **Phone Clip *time***, artist **Phone**.
3. Play it from the deck like anything else.

Press ✕ to throw the clip away and go back to recording.

Good to know

- Loading a clip onto a deck replaces what is on that deck. Send it to a deck that is not on air.
- Phone clips are saved in a phone-recordings folder on this computer. They are not added to the Library and do not appear on your other computers.
- ▶ **MONITOR** and the editor's playback are heard on this computer only.
- If **DEVICE** says **No devices found**, check that the interface is connected and that Ether is allowed to use the microphone.

13. Show+

What it's for

Show+ is Ether's video studio. It builds a live picture from your camera, your screen, application windows, a logo and remote guests, and sends that picture to YouTube, Twitch, Facebook or any RTMP service, records it to a file, or both.

Where to find it

- **☰ menu** → **Show+**, or **Tools** → **Monitors** → **Show+**: opens Show+ in its own window.
- **Tools** → **Show+**: opens Show+ in the main window. To get back to the board, open the **☰ menu** and choose **Return to Mixer**.

(Show+ is not the same as **Show+ DAW**, which is a separate audio editor. See *Show+ DAW: send and save* at the end of this chapter.)

Plan: Local (every plan). Remote guests come through Ether's guest service: **Show+ remote guests** needs **Live 128, Live 320 or Network**.

The screen

- The large area on the left is the **program**: exactly what goes out. It is always shown, whatever tab is open.
- The right side has four tabs: **ENGINE**, **SHOW+**, **SOURCES** and **QUALITY**.
- The bar along the bottom has **Record** and **CC** (captions).

When Show+ opens it turns on your camera and microphone. Your camera appears as a source called **Host**.

Step 1. Add sources (SOURCES tab)

Under **SOURCES**:

- **+ Screen**: a whole display. If you have more than one, pick it from the list.
- **+ Window**: one application window. Pick it from the list.
- **+ Camera**: another camera. If you have more than one, pick it from the list.
- **+ Logo**: a PNG, JPEG or WebP image. It is placed as a small logo in the top-right corner.

Each source in the list has:

- **+** to put it in the picture (it turns to **−** to take it out).
- **×** to remove the source. (Host cannot be removed. A guest removed here stays connected.)

Step 2. Arrange the picture

On the program picture:

1. Click a layer to select it.
2. Drag it to move it; drag its edges or corners to resize. Layers snap to edges and the centre.
3. Arrow keys nudge the selected layer; **Shift + arrow** moves it further.
4. Under the picture, the selected layer shows its position and size, an **opacity** slider, and **Chroma OFF** ▾. Open Chroma to switch on **CHROMA KEY** for a green screen, with a **Key color** and **Tolerance**.

Layout presets above the picture arrange all layers at once: **Solo**, **2-up H**, **2-up V**, **3-up**, **4-up**, **PiP** and **Focus**.

In the ENGINE tab:

- **SCENE (*n*)** lists the layers in the picture. Drag a row up or down to change which layer is on top. Click a row to select it. × takes it out of the picture.
- **EFFECTS** (for the selected layer): **Border**, **Radius**, **Shadow**, a text **Label** with its **Size** and **Colors**, and **Reset Effects**.

Step 3. Save scenes and switch between them (ENGINE tab)

A scene is a saved arrangement of layers.

1. Arrange the picture, then press **+ Save Current** under **SCENES**. It is named *Scene 1*, *Scene 2*…
2. Click a scene's name to switch to it.
3. ⟳ overwrites a scene with the current arrangement. × deletes it.
4. **Transition** sets how scenes change: **Cut**, **Cross Fade**, or a **Wipe** (left, right, up, down). For anything but Cut, set the **Duration** in milliseconds (100–3000).

Step 4. Set the quality (QUALITY tab)

Under **ENCODER**: **Resolution** (1280×720 up to 3840×2160), **FPS** (24, 30, 60), **Bitrate**, **Codec** (H.264 or H.265) and **Encoder** (**Auto (best available)**, a graphics-card encoder, or **Software**). Leave Encoder on Auto unless you know your machine.

Step 5. Go live (SHOW+ tab)

Under **RTMP DESTINATIONS**:

1. Pick the service: **YouTube Live**, **Twitch**, **Facebook Live**, **X (Twitter)**, **Kick** or **Custom RTMP**. The address fills in; a help line tells you where to find your key.
2. Paste your **Stream key**. Give it a **Label** if you like.
3. Optional: a **Backup RTMP URL** (and key) that Ether switches to if the main address fails to connect.
4. To send to several services at once, press **+ Add Destination** and repeat. × removes a destination.
5. Press ▶ **Go Live (*n* destinations)**. Each destination shows **CONNECTING…**, then **LIVE** with its running time, or **RECONNECTING…** / **FAILED**.
6. Press ■ **Stop All Streams** to end.

Record the show

To record the finished program (what viewers see):

1. In the **ENGINE** tab, under **RECORDING**, press **…** and choose where to save the MP4 file.
2. Press ● **Start Recording**. Press ■ **Stop Recording** to finish.

STATUS under it shows what is running (**Idle — no active sinks.** when nothing is). The lights at the top of the ENGINE tab show **ENGINE**, **LIVE** and **REC**.

Record in the bottom bar is different: it records **your own camera and microphone only** (not the program) to a .webm file you choose. Press it again to stop.

Remote guests (SHOW+ tab → GUESTS)

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network.

1. Under **GUESTS**, press **Enable** next to **Guest access**.
2. Share the invite: **Copy** the link, read out the four-digit room code, show the QR code, or fill in **EMAIL INVITE** (their email, optional name and message) and press **Send Invite**.
3. While Ether gets connection details it says *Getting connection credentials…*. If it cannot, it says *Connection relay unavailable* and guests cannot connect.
4. When a guest arrives you see **"*name*" wants to join**. Press **Accept** or **Deny**.
5. Each accepted guest has a tile with buttons to add them to the picture or take them out, **Mute** / **Unmute**, and **Remove guest**. Guests also appear as sources marked **GUEST**.

Audio (SHOW+ tab → AUDIO)

- **Mic Input**: the microphone used for your camera source.
- **Output Device**: where you hear guests and your own monitor.
- **Self-Monitor**: **On** to hear yourself in your headphones; **Monitor** sets that level.

These settings are remembered on this computer.

Live captions (CC)

Press **CC** in the bottom bar to show live captions on the Show+ screen. Pick the microphone they listen to in the list beside it. The first time, Ether downloads its speech model (about 40 MB), so it needs an internet connection once.

Show+ DAW: send and save

Where to find it: ☰ menu → Show+ DAW, or **Tools → Show+ DAW**. It opens in its own window. **Send to Studio** on a Library song (Chapter 5) also opens it.

Plan: Local (every plan).

This section covers getting audio out of the DAW. All of these buttons are in the toolbar along the top of the DAW window, and each reports what happened in the DAW's status line.

Send the mix to a deck (To Deck)

1. Press **To Deck** ▾ and pick **Deck A**, **Deck B** or **Deck C**.

2. Ether mixes every track that isn't muted (only the soloed tracks, if any are soloed) and says **Rendering for Deck A…**.
3. The mix is loaded onto that deck as **Show+ Mix**. The status says ✓ **Sent to Deck A**.

If the deck can't take it, the status says **Couldn't send to Deck A** with the reason. With nothing on the tracks it says **Nothing to send.**

Export a WAV file

1. Press **Export** ▾.
2. Choose **Export Mix (one WAV)** for the finished mix, or **Export Stems (one WAV per track)** for each track on its own.
3. The Save window opens. Pick the folder and name, and press Save.
   - **Export Mix** writes one WAV file there. The status says ✓ **Exported:** and the file's location.
   - **Export Stems** writes one WAV per track in that folder, each named after the name you typed plus the track name. The status says ✓ **Exported N stems**. Pressing Cancel in the Save window says **Stem export cancelled.**

Save the session

Press 💾 (Save session to disk). The Save window opens; pick where to keep the session file and press Save. The status says ✓ **Saved session**. Takes you recorded in the DAW but haven't bounced are not kept in the session file; the status says how many were skipped.

When nothing was written

Ether only writes into the place you picked in the Save window. If a file could not be written, the status says so in red instead of claiming success: ✗ **Export failed:**, ✗ **Stem "…" not written:** or ✗ **Save failed:**, followed by the reason.

Good to know

- Show+ needs permission to use the camera, the microphone and screen capture. If **+ Camera** says *No cameras detected. Check permissions.*, check your operating system's privacy settings.
- ● **Start Recording** stays greyed until you have chosen a file with **…**.
- Captions are shown on your Show+ screen. They are not part of the picture you stream or record.
- Stream keys are private. Anyone with your key can broadcast on your channel.
- Guests connect through Ether's guest service on the internet. The rest of Show+ (sources, scenes, streaming to your own RTMP services, recording) runs on this computer.

14. Streaming

What it's for

This chapter covers how your station gets from the board to your listeners. Ether sends the station's programme to an Icecast server, so anyone with the listener link can tune in. You start and stop that stream with the **ON AIR** button or from **Stream Manager**. Ether can also send the title of each song to your stream, TuneIn, an RDS encoder or a webhook (**Stream Metadata Outputs**). Before it reaches the stream, the programme can go through the **Processor**. That is a loudness ride and a true-peak limiter, with a master EQ in front of them. This chapter also covers where your own speakers, headphones (PFL) and the aux play on this computer (the **Patch Bay** and **Master Out**). Last, it covers the sound settings that apply to every source.

Where to find it

- **ON AIR** button: top bar, just left of the ☰ menu button.
- Stream settings and status: **File** → **Settings** → **Broadcast**.
- Stream Manager: ☰ → **Stream Manager**, or **Tools** → **Stream Manager**.
- Song titles to your stream and other outputs: **File** → **Settings** → **Broadcast** → **Stream Metadata Outputs**.
- Server address, mount, password and bitrate for each station: **Tools** → **Station Manager**, then **Rename** on the station, or **Stream Manager** (the same settings).
- Processor: **Master Out** → **Processor** → **OPEN**, or ☰ → **Processor**, or **Tools** → **Monitors** → **Processor**.
- Patch Bay: ☰ → **Patch Bay**, or **Tools** → **Patch Bay**.
- Master Out: the panel on the right of the main screen. **Tools** → **Monitors** → **Master Output** opens it in its own window.
- Sound settings: **File** → **Settings** → **Audio** and **File** → **Settings** → **Audio Devices**.

Plan:

- Streaming to **your own Icecast server**: Local (every plan).
- Streaming to **Ether's hosted stream**: Live 128, Live 320 or Network.
- Stream Manager and Stream Metadata Outputs run on this computer: Local (every plan). The **Listen live** link in Stream Manager is your public listener page: Local (every plan).
- The Processor, Patch Bay, Master Out and the Audio settings run on this computer alone: Local (every plan).

Set up where the stream goes

Each station streams to its own Icecast mount. You set these details once per station.

1. Open **Tools** → **Station Manager**.
2. On your station's card, press **Rename**. The edit form opens.
3. Under **ICECAST**, fill in:
   - **Server URL**: the address of your Icecast server, for example `stream.example.com` or an IP address. If your server does not use port 8000, write the port after the address, for example `stream.example.com:8443`. With no port written, Ether uses 8000.

- **Mount**: the mount point, for example `/live`.
- **Password**: the Icecast source password.
- **Bitrate**: 64 to 320 kbps.

4. Press **Save Changes**.

If you leave **Server URL** blank, Ether streams to Ether's hosted server. If you leave **Password** blank, Ether uses `hackme`. If you leave **Mount** blank, Ether uses `/live`.

You can also change the server for the station you are working on from **Settings** → **Broadcast**. Next to the server address at the top, press **Edit**, type the new address and press **Save** (or Enter). Press ✕ or Esc to cancel.

Stream Manager

Stream Manager is the full view of the stream for the station you are working on. It is the **same stream as the ON AIR button**. Starting or stopping it here does exactly what ON AIR does, and the two always agree.

1. Open ☰ → **Stream Manager** (or **Tools** → **Stream Manager**). It opens in its own window and shows the station you are working on.
2. Read the status at the top:
   - **OFF AIR**, **CONNECTING…**, **ON AIR** or **ERROR**. While on air, it shows how long, for example *"on air 1m 14s"*.
   - **Sending to**: the server, port and mount the stream goes to.
   - **Bitrate**: while on air, what the encoder is really sending. Otherwise the station's setting, marked **(set)**.
   - **Listeners**: how many people are listening to this mount right now. Ether reads this from your Icecast server's own status page, every 15 seconds while on air.
3. Under **Listen live** is your station's public listener page. Press **Copy** to copy the address, or **Open** to open it in your browser. If the station has no listener page yet, it says to turn one on in **Settings** → **Broadcast** → **Your listener page**.
4. To change where the stream goes, edit the fields under **Icecast server for this station**: the server, the mount, the password and the bitrate (64 to 320 kbps). Leave the password blank to keep the one already set. Press **Save settings**. These are the same settings as Station Manager; there is only one set.
5. Press ▶ **Start streaming** to start the stream. Press ■ **Stop streaming** to stop. The ON AIR button on the main screen changes with it.

- Saved settings are used the next time the stream starts. If you save while on air, Ether says so. Stop and start the stream to switch over.
- If the listener count cannot be read (the server does not answer, or its status page is off), the box shows **unknown** and the reason. Ether never guesses. **mount not on server** means the server has no stream on that mount right now.
- If the stream keeps failing, the status shows **ERROR** with the server's own reason. For example: "*The server refused the stream (403): another computer may be sending to this mount, or the password is wrong. Ether tries again every 30 seconds; press Stop to end it.*" ■ **Stop streaming** stays on screen while Ether retries.

Start streaming

Start streaming sends your station to your stream server, so listeners can hear it. The quickest place is ☰ → **Stream Manager** (above) or the **OFF AIR** button in the top bar; both do the same thing.

From the top bar:

1. Press **OFF AIR**.
2. The button turns amber and reads **GOING LIVE…** while Ether connects to the server.
3. When the server accepts the stream, the button turns red and reads **ON AIR**.
4. To stop, press the button again. It goes back to **OFF AIR**.

The button only shows the station you are working on. If you switch to another station, the button shows that station's stream. Another station can stay on air while you build a different one.

From Settings → Broadcast:

1. Open **File** → **Settings** → **Broadcast**. The **Broadcast** section lists every station on this computer.
2. Each station shows **ONLINE** or **OFFLINE**, and its **Listener URL**. Press **Copy** to copy the listener link.
3. Press ▶ **GO LIVE — Stream to Icecast** to start that station's stream.
4. Press ■ **STOP STREAM** to stop it.

A status line under each station shows **CONNECTING…**, **LIVE** (with how long it has been live) or **ERROR** (with the message). A green or red line under the list shows the result of your last start, for example "✓ *Streaming → server:8000/live*".

The dot next to the server address at the top shows whether that server answers: **ONLINE**, **OFFLINE** or **CHECKING**. Press **Refresh** to check again.

Stream Metadata Outputs (song titles)

Every time a song starts on a station, Ether sends **"Artist - Title"** to each output you add here, all at once. Use it to show the song title on your stream, in TuneIn, on an FM radio's display (RDS), or in your own tools. Outputs belong to the station you are working on and are kept on this computer. Ether sends them in the background, so titles keep going out with no window open.

Kinds of output

- **Icecast 2**: the song title on an Icecast mount. Tick **This station's own stream (server, mount and password from Stream Manager)** to use the stream ON AIR sends. Untick it to type another server's **Server host**, **Port**, **Mount point**, **Admin username**, **Admin password** and **Use HTTPS**.
- **Shoutcast**: a Shoutcast server. Fill in **Server host**, **Port**, **Stream ID (sid)**, **Version** (v1 or v2) and **Admin password**.
- **TuneIn AIR**: your **Partner ID**, **Partner Key** and **Station ID**. You get these from tunein.com/broadcasters.
- **RDS Encoder (Serial)**: an FM RDS encoder on a serial (COM) port. Pick the **Serial port** (the screen lists the ports this computer has), the **Baud rate** and the **Encoder type**: Inovonics, Audemat / WorldCast, Deva, or Generic / plain text. The text is cut to 64 characters.
- **Custom Webhook**: Ether sends the song as JSON (title, artist, album, duration, time) to your **Webhook URL**, by POST or PUT, with an optional user name and password.

Add an output

1. Open **File** → **Settings** → **Broadcast** and go to **Stream Metadata Outputs**. It shows the station you are working on.
2. Under **+ ADD A NEW METADATA OUTPUT**, press the kind you want.
3. Give it a **Name** and fill in the fields. Leave **Enabled** ticked.
4. Press **Save**.
5. Press **Test** on its row. Ether sends the station's current song to that output now. The row says what was sent ("✓ *Sent …*") or why it failed.

Manage outputs

- **ON / OFF** pauses an output or turns it back on.
- **Edit** changes it. **Del** deletes it after you confirm.
- Each row shows its last result (**OK**, or **ERROR** with the reason, for example "*HTTP 401*"), how many titles it has sent, when it last sent, and the last title it sent.

Good to know for outputs:

- A slow or failing output never holds up the others.
- **Test** sends "*Ether - Test from Ether*" when nothing has played on the station since Ether started.
- Outputs are not copied to your other computers. A serial port and a server password belong to the computer that sends.
- An Icecast output can only set a title while that mount has a stream on it. With nothing streaming, the server answers with an error.

The Processor (loudness ride and limiter)

The Processor shapes the station's sound after the mix, in this order:

- **PGM**: the **GEQ**, a 10-band master EQ for the whole programme.
- **MONITOR** (your local output): the **RIDE** (loudness ride), then the **LIMITER** (true-peak limiter).
- **STREAM** (what listeners get): its own **RIDE**, then **LIMITER**.

Turn processing on

Processing is **off** by default. When it is off, the sound passes through untouched.

1. Open **File** → **Settings** → **Broadcast**, then go to **Audio Processing**.
2. Turn on **Process stream** to process what listeners hear.
3. Turn on **Process local output** to process this computer's speakers. This does not change the stream.
4. With either one on, **Live meters** appear. Below them, a line says what is running, for example "*Riding to −14 LUFS · limiter holds −1.0 dBTP · stream only.*"

Each station has its own settings. A change reaches the audio engine within a few seconds.

Adjust the chain

1. Open the Processor: **Master Out** → **Processor** → **OPEN**. It opens in its own window. **Master Out** → **Master EQ** → **OPEN** opens the same window with the GEQ selected.

2. Tap a module in the strip. The editor below names it, for example "*editing: MONITOR · RIDE*".
3. Change the controls. Each change goes to air at once and is saved for this station.
   - **GEQ**: ten band faders over a live spectrum, **FLAT** (all bands to 0 dB), and **IN / OUT**.
   - **RIDE**: Target (the loudness it aims for), Rate (how fast it moves), Clamp (how far it may go).
   - **LIMITER**: Ceiling and Release.
4. **LINKED ⇄** means the stream runs the same settings as the monitor. Press it to **SPLIT**. The stream then gets its own settings, starting as a copy of the monitor. Press **SPLIT** again to link them back.

The meters on the right stay in view: **IN · PGM**, **OUT · MON** and **OUT · STR**. Below them are the ride and limiter meters and the loudness panels for **Monitor** and **Stream**.

Presets

1. Pick a preset from **Arm a preset…**. Nothing changes on air yet.
2. A yellow line shows what **TAKE** will change.
3. Press **TAKE ▸ (preset name)** to apply it, or **DISARM** to drop it.

- **SAVE** overwrites your own active preset. You cannot overwrite a built-in preset.
- To make a new preset, type a name in **Save as…** and press **SAVE AS**.
- **· modified** next to the preset name means the rack no longer matches that preset.
- A preset never turns processing on or off. That stays with the two switches in Settings → Broadcast.

Bypass (testing only)

BYP on the ride or the limiter takes that module out of the chain straight away. A yellow banner warns you, for example "*STREAM: LIMITER BYPASSED — nothing is holding the ceiling on air*". Bypass is never saved. It clears when Ether restarts. Press **BYP** again to put the module back **IN**. Master Out also shows **BYPASSED** next to **Processor** while a bypass is on.

Master Out

Master Out is the panel on the right of the main screen.

- **Bus meters** and **LIM** (how hard the limiter is working).
- **Master** fader: the station's programme level.
- **Monitor** fader: your local listening level.
- **Limiter**: the limiter's live reading.
- **Master EQ → OPEN** and **Processor → OPEN**: open the Processor (see above).
- **Station** (click to open): **On Air** shows **LIVE** while programme audio is playing, and **STBY** when it is not. **Stream** shows the station's real stream state: **ON AIR**, **CONNECTING**, **ERROR** or **OFF** (the same as Stream Manager). **Uptime** and **Next Break** are shown too.
- **Station monitors**: one strip for each station on this computer.
  - **MUTE** silences that station's local speakers and keeps the level. Press **MUTED** to bring the sound back.
  - Open a strip to get its **Monitor** fader (local speakers only) and the **Park page control** switch (see chapter 16).
  - A line shows which device the station's Master really plays to, and opens the Patch Bay.
- The arrow at the top left collapses the panel to a thin meter strip. The pop-out icon opens Master Out in its own window.

Monitor levels are what you hear in the room. They never change the stream.

The Patch Bay (where this computer plays)

The Patch Bay is the one place where you choose which device each output plays to. Its settings are saved for this computer only.

Outputs

Each station has three rows:

- **Master**: the station's local output, after the MONITOR fader. If nothing is patched, it plays on the Windows default device.
- **Cue (PFL)**: where PFL plays. If nothing is patched, PFL plays over Master.
- **Aux**: the aux monitor bus. If nothing is patched, the aux is silent.

The columns are every channel pair on every output device (for example **1-2**, **3-4**).

1. Open ☰ → **Patch Bay**.
2. Click a square to connect that output to that device's channels. Click it again to disconnect.
3. One output can play to up to 4 devices at once.
4. The lines under the grid say what the engine really has open. For example: **Live** with the device name, or **MISSING** in red if the device is not connected. Ether never plays somewhere else in its place.
5. Press **Refresh output devices** after you plug in a new device.

If the Master device stalls, switch to the Windows default: choose **On**, **Off** or **Not set**. When it is **Not set**, a stalling device is shown in red and retried. Ether never switches on its own.

Inputs

Under each station's outputs is an **Inputs** grid. Its rows are the station's source faders. Its columns are every input on this computer, the Park mics, and the Remote Link feed.

1. Click a square to bring that input in on that fader. The fader's SOURCE on the board changes with it.
2. Click it again to disconnect.
3. The lines under the grid say what each fader is receiving.
4. Press **Refresh inputs** after you plug in a new device.

If the station has no source faders, the grid says so. Add one with **+** on the board first.

Settings → Audio Devices

- **Where each station plays**: this is a pointer to the Patch Bay (see above).
- **Phone hybrid input**: the input your phone hybrid or caller audio is connected to. The Phone Desk uses it. The chosen input shows **ACTIVE**.
- **Track Editor preview player**: where the Track Editor plays when you audition a cut. It is not the PFL. The chosen output shows **PREVIEW**.
- ↻ **Rescan Devices**: looks for devices again.

- **Segue overlap (auto)**: how many seconds the next song starts before the current one ends, 0 to 10. **off** means wait for the end. The outgoing song always plays to its natural end. This is saved with the station.

Settings → Audio

Loudness & faders

- **Loudness target**: every file on any fader (songs, sweepers, carts, announcements, the jukebox) plays at this loudness. Ether measures each file once and sets its gain to match. The range is −40 to −5 LUFS. Type a value and press **Save**. **now:** shows the stored value. A new target applies to each file from its next load. The line below shows how many files have been measured and how many are waiting.
- **Fader smoothing**: how long every level move takes, so a move never clicks. The range is 0 to 500 ms.
- **Fader maximum (top of travel)**: the top level for **Channel faders**, **AUX rows**, **MASTER** and **MONITOR**, from 0 to +10 dB.
- **How a fader moves**: Shift-drag fine factor, mouse wheel step, arrow key step and Shift + arrow step.
- The fader law points: **Add a point**, **Remove**, then **Save law**.

PFL (pre-fader listen)

- PFL plays a channel in this station's local output, or in the **PFL output** if you patched one (the Cue row in the Patch Bay).
- **Programme dip**: how far the programme drops in your local output while any PFL is on. 0 dB means no dip. −60 dB means almost gone. Air and the stream are never affected.
- The line below says whether the value is saved for this station.

Mic Inputs (on air)

- Each mic channel on the board is listed with the engine's live state.
- The input itself is chosen in the Patch Bay. Press **Patch Bay** to go there. Press **Disconnect** to remove the input; the channel stays set to Mic.
- **Input gain**: digital gain from −10 to +40 dB. Set the mic's preamp first, then trim here.
- To hear yourself, use your interface's direct monitor. The engine's path back to your headphones is too late to talk against.

Ducker

The Ducker sets how far the programme drops when a source channel with **DUCK ON** has audio.

- **Depth** (dB down), **Hold**, **Release**, **Attack** and **Threshold**. Each control has a hint under it.
- **Which decks step back**: ticked decks duck under a source. Unticked decks play through at full level.
- **Reset to the starting values** puts the starting values back. If the station has no ducker settings yet, the panel says the music is not ducked and offers **Use the starting values**.

These settings are for the station you are working on.

Good to know

- **The stream starts from the programme, not from your speakers.** Patch Bay devices, the MONITOR fader and the station monitor strips never change what listeners hear. If no Master device is open, the Patch Bay says the station runs on its own clock and the stream keeps going.
- **The stream goes to the port written in the server address**, for example `stream.example.com:8443`. With no port written, it goes to port 8000. The format is always MP3. The **Format** choice in Station Manager does not change the stream.
- **Settings → Broadcast always shows port 8000** in its result line ("*✓ Streaming → server:8000/live*") and checks the server's ONLINE dot and builds each station's **Listener URL** with port 8000, even when you wrote another port. Stream Manager's **Sending to** shows the real port.
- **Edit in Settings → Broadcast changes only the station you are working on**, even though the server appears above the whole list.
- **If the stream fails three times within 10 seconds**, Ether shows **ERROR** with the server's reason, then *"Ether tries again every 30 seconds; press Stop to end it."* It keeps trying until you stop it.
- **After an update, fully close and reopen Ether.** The audio engine does not reload on its own. Several screens say this if the running engine is too old. For example, the Processor may say the limiter ceiling is "not reported".
- **Once you have changed anything in the Processor window, set the loudness target there.** After that, the **Target loudness** box in Settings → Broadcast → Audio Processing no longer changes what runs.
- **A red line in the Processor** ("*The engine did not accept that*") means nothing changed on air. The rack shows what is really running.

15. Remote Link

What it's for

The Remote Link carries a live feed from one Ether computer to a fader on another, in about a fifth of a second. Use it for a remote broadcast: the computer at the venue sends its board to the studio, and at the studio the feed lands on a fader whose source is **Link**. From there it is a channel like any other — its meter, fader, ON button, the ducker, and the station's processing. The listener stream is about 8 seconds behind, far too late to cue from; the Link is not.

The computer that **sends** is the one that owns the key. The computer that **receives** picks the sending computer on a fader set to Link.

Where to find it

- ☰ menu → **Remote Link** (the button's tooltip reads "Take a remote broadcast from another Ether computer, or send this station to another (SEND TO)"). It opens Settings on the Remote Link page.
- **Settings** → **Remote Link**.
- On the board: any source fader's source menu → **Link (network feed)**.

The page has three boxes: **This computer's link key**, **Feed in — the fader set to Link**, and **SEND FEED TO another computer**.

Plan:

- Sending to a typed address, and pasting a key line by hand: Local (every plan).
- Picking a computer on your account, or pairing a guest computer with a code: Live 128, Live 320 or Network.
- Sending through Ether's relay (no address to type): Live 128, Live 320 or Network.

Receive a remote feed (the studio side)

1. On the board, pick a source fader. Open its source menu and choose **Link (network feed)**.
2. The strip now shows ● **LINK** and a list: **— pick the sending computer —**. It lists the other computers on your Ether account.
3. Pick the computer that will send. Its key is fetched for you; there is nothing to copy.
   - A computer shows **not shared yet — open Ether on it** until Ether has been opened on it. It cannot be picked until then.
4. The fader now shows the sender's name and key fingerprint, e.g. ← **VENUE-PC · key …**. Compare that fingerprint with the one on the sending computer's screen (Settings → Remote Link → **Key**).
5. When the sending computer starts its feed, the fader carries it. Bring the fader up and turn the channel ON as you would any source.

You can do the same from **Settings** → **Remote Link** → **Feed in**: the **Takes the feed of** row shows the same picker.

From a computer on a different Ether account (a guest):

1. On the sending computer, go to Settings → Remote Link → **This computer's link key** and press **Show a pairing code**. An 8-character code appears with a countdown.
2. On the receiving computer, type the code into **guest code XXXX-XXXX** (on the strip or in **Takes the feed of**) and press **Pair** (or Enter).
3. The code works once and expires after 10 minutes. Press **New pairing code** for another.

The advanced way (paste a key line):

1. On the sending computer: **Key** → **Advanced — copy the key as a line** → **Copy link key line**. The line is copied (if the copy fails, select the line shown and copy it).
2. On the receiving computer: **Advanced — paste a link key line** → paste it. It is applied when you paste or press Enter. The line starts with `ether-link:1:`.

Feed in settings

These appear once a fader is set to Link. Each one is applied when you leave the box.

- **Jitter buffer** — how much audio the Link holds to ride out network wobble, in milliseconds. More means fewer dropouts and more delay. The allowed range and the default are shown beside the box.
- **Listen on UDP port** — the port this computer listens on, for every station on it. If a router forwards the remote's traffic to this computer, it points at this port. The default and the port in use are shown.
- **Auto-cut on loss** — **ON** / **OFF**, and **turn the channel OFF after … s of loss**. When ON, if the Link is lost for that long the channel is turned OFF, so the remote never comes back to air unannounced. It is OFF to start with: the channel just goes silent.

The coloured line next to **Feed in** says what the Link is doing right now. Below the settings, a line of live numbers shows latency (network + buffered), jitter, kb/s, packets received and lost, dropouts, refused keys and reconnects.

Allowing a computer the first time (relay)

When a computer sends to this station through Ether's relay for the first time, and the Link fader does not already take its feed, an amber box appears at the top of Settings → Remote Link: "**VENUE-PC wants to send a feed to [station]'s Link fader. Allow it?**" Press **Allow**. It is asked once and remembered after.

Cutting a sender off

- On the strip, press ✕ next to the sender's name, or
- In Settings → Remote Link, press **Forget key — cut [name] off**.

That fader no longer takes that computer's feed until it is paired again.

Send this station to another computer (SEND TO)

1. Go to Settings → Remote Link → **SEND FEED TO another computer**.
2. In **Computer · station**, pick where the feed goes. The list shows each station on your account and the computer that airs it. A line that cannot be used is greyed and says why.
   - If the list is empty: "No computer airs a station on this account yet — a station's computer is set when it takes over playout."

3. Leave the address empty to send through **Ether's relay**: no address or port to type, and no router setup at either end. The first time, the receiving computer is asked to allow this one (see above).
4. To send **directly** instead, open **Advanced: send directly to an address instead** and type that computer's public address and **port**. Its router must forward that port to it.
5. Pick a **Bitrate** (64 to 256 kb/s; the default is marked). The audio is Opus, stereo, 48 kHz.
6. **Loss protection (FEC)** — **ON** / **OFF**. With it ON and nothing lost, the audio is full quality. When the far end reports loss, part of the audio is coded as speech to carry a spare copy, which is less clean on music.
7. Press ▶ **SEND FEED TO [computer · station]**. The line next to the heading turns to **SENDING …**.
8. To stop, press ■ **STOP THE FEED**.

What is sent is this station's programme **before** its processing, so the board it lands on processes it once. Sending the same station from the venue to the studio is the normal case. While sending, the settings above are locked, and a line of live numbers shows round-trip time, frames sent, send errors, and what the receiving computer reports back (received, lost, buffer, jitter).

This computer's link key

- **Key** shows this computer's key fingerprint, its number and when it was made. If there is no key yet, one is made the first time it is needed.
- **Replace key…** → **Replace — every fader holding the old key stops taking this feed** makes a new key. Press **Keep** to back out. Faders on your own account that picked this computer from the list pick up the new key within about a minute. Faders paired with a code or a pasted line stop taking this computer's feed until they are paired again.

Good to know

- The Remote Link needs Ether's audio engine service. If it is not running, the page says: "The Remote Link needs the audio engine service — fully close and reopen Ether."
- The Link goes on a source fader only.
- A computer cannot feed its own faders; that line is refused in the **Computer · station** list.
- The receiving fader takes one sender at a time. A second computer trying to send to the same fader is refused and counted ("second sender refused").
- Only the computer whose key the fader holds is accepted; a wrong key is refused and counted ("key refused").
- The relay works between computers on the **same** Ether account. For a guest computer on another account, use a typed address.
- A pairing code works once, for 10 minutes.
- The **SRT → UDP fallback** row is shown but cannot be changed: this build sends UDP only.
- A Link coming up, being lost, and a key being refused are recorded in the Health Monitor.

16. The Park page

What it's for

The Park page is a web page for the people walking the park, on their own phone. It shows the time, what is on air, any announcement playing right now, tonight's closing time and today's announcements. Staff who log in can also change tonight's closing time, turn the park's sound up or down, MUTE it, fire carts 1 to 8, listen to what the park speakers are playing, and talk over the park speakers. Nothing needs to be installed: it opens in an ordinary phone browser. The page is hosted on the internet, so the address keeps working even when the studio computer is off; it then says the station isn't reporting.

Where to find it

- **The page's address:** in Ether, **Settings** → **Links** → **Park page**. There is one line per station, with **Open** and **Copy**. The address is `park.ether-cast.com/` followed by the station's public page name.
- **Its settings: Settings** → **Park Page** (two sections: **Park page — Listen** and **Park page — Hold to talk**).
- **The studio's lock and the park's sound in Ether: Monitors** → **Master Output** → **Station Monitors**, on the station's strip.

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network

Get the address to your staff

1. Open **Settings** → **Links** and pick **Park page**.
2. Find the line for your station. If it says "*this station has no public page address yet*", the station needs a public page address first.
3. Press **Copy** and text or post the address. Press **Open** to see the page yourself.

Anyone with the address can look at the page. To make changes, a person must log in (see below).

Who can log in

Staff log in on the Park page with a **username** and **PIN**. These are your Ether users: a user added in **Settings** → **Station** → **Users & Security** with a PIN can log in to the Park page with that name and PIN (a user without a PIN cannot). The same users work on every station of the account.

- If someone's PIN is changed or the user is removed, their phone is logged out the next time the page checks.
- Too many wrong PINs locks that user out for a while; the page says when they can try again.

Use the Park page (on the phone)

1. Open the address. Without logging in, the page is view only and says "*View only. Log in to make changes.*"
2. Press **LOG IN**, type your **Username** and **PIN**, and press **LOG IN**. The page now shows "*Logged in:* ". It stays logged in on that phone until you press **LOG OUT**.

The page has three columns.

Left — what is happening

- The clock.
- **ANNOUNCEMENT ON AIR** appears while an announcement is playing, with its name and the seconds left.
- **Now playing** — the song and the time left. "*Station is off air*" or "*Nothing playing*" when there is nothing.
- **Park closes tonight** — tonight's closing time.
- **Announcements today** — every announcement for today, in the order it will play, with its time. Lines timed from closing say so (for example "*20 min before closing*"). Each line can show **ON AIR NOW**, **Played**, **Failed**, **Skipped** or **Did not play**.

Middle — Park sound

- One big fader and a **MUTE** button. The fader is the station's speaker level in the studio (what the park hears).
- Under it, a line says who last changed the sound and when, for example "*Muted from Park page by Ryan, 8:42 PM*".
- Logged-in staff also see **LISTEN** and **TAP TO TALK** here.

Right — Carts

- Eight buttons, **1** to **8**: the first eight carts on the station's cart wall. Empty ones say **Empty**.

Change tonight's closing time

1. Log in.
2. Tap the time under **Park closes tonight**.
3. Set the new time and press **SAVE** (or **Cancel** to keep the old one).
4. The page shows "*Saved — waiting for the station to confirm…*", then "*Saved. The announcements below have moved with it.*" Announcements timed from closing move with the new time.

This changes **tonight only**. Other days, and the weekday closing times, are not touched.

Turn the park's sound up, down or off

1. Log in.
2. Drag the fader. It moves from where it is — touching it does not make it jump. You can also double-tap the level readout to type an exact level in dB. On a computer, the mouse wheel and arrow keys also move it.
3. Tap **MUTE** to silence the park. It turns to **MUTED**. Tap it again to bring the sound back at the level it had.

Any logged-in person can change or undo anyone's change. Ether shows the same "who and when" line on the station's strip.

Fire a cart

1. Log in.
2. Tap a cart button. While it plays, the button shows the time left.
3. Tap the same button again to stop it.

Listen to the park on your phone

Listen plays, on your own phone only, everything the park hears from the studio: every MAIN and AUX source (music, announcements, commercials, sound effects, carts), after the station's speaker level and MUTE. Your phone's volume never changes the park.

Set it up first, in Ether (Settings → Park Page → Park page — Listen):

1. **Listen quality** — a number from 6 to 510 kbps. Press **Save**.
2. **Channels** — **Mono** or **Stereo**. Press **Save**.
3. **Frame length** — 2.5, 5, 10, 20, 40 or 60 ms. Shorter means less delay. Press **Save**.
4. **Listener buffer (on the phone)** — 0 to 4000 ms. More means fewer dropouts on a weak connection, but more delay (0 = the phone's own minimum). Press **Save**.

Each row shows **now:** and the stored value. Listen stays off for the station until all four are set; the panel says "*Listen is available on this station's Park page.*" once they are. A new setting applies the next time someone presses Listen.

On the phone:

1. Log in and tap **LISTEN**. It turns to **LISTENING**.
2. Tap it again to stop.

If the station is not set up, the button says "*Listen isn't set up on this station*". Nothing is sent unless someone is listening, and Listen never touches the on-air stream or playout.

Talk over the park speakers (TAP TO TALK)

There are two Park mics, **Park Mic 1** and **Park Mic 2**. Each is an input like a sound-card mic.

Set it up first, in Ether:

1. On the board, set a fader's source to **Mic** and pick **Park Mic 1 (Park page)** (or Park Mic 2). Put each Park mic on one fader only.
2. The fader's **MAIN** button decides where the voice goes: lit = in the park **and** on air; not lit = in the park only. **DUCK** dips the music while someone talks. Any processing (EQ, compressor) goes in that fader's own rack.
3. Open **Settings** → **Park Page** → **Park page — Hold to talk**. For each Park mic, type the **name on the phone** (up to 40 characters) and press **Save**. Under each mic the panel shows which fader it is on and whether MAIN is lit.
4. Set **Park mic buffer** (20 to 1000 ms; more = a steadier voice on a weak signal, a little more delay) and press **Save**.

5. Click **Phone echo cancellation**, **Phone noise suppression** and **Phone automatic gain** to set each ON or OFF. Talk stays off until these three are set.

On the phone:

1. Log in. If there are two Park mics, pick one by its name.
2. Tap **TAP TO TALK**. The first time, the phone asks for permission to use the microphone — allow it.
3. Wait for green **TALK NOW**, then talk. (**CONNECTING…** means not yet.)
4. Tap again to stop. There is no time limit.
5. When you are done for a while, tap **Turn the microphone off**.

If the line drops during a talk, the button says **DISCONNECTED** and stays on until you tap it. Only one person can talk on a mic at a time; the other phones show who is talking. While you talk, Listen on your own phone goes quiet so the phone does not feed back into itself.

In Ether: while someone talks, the Park mic's fader shows "*Talking now: (Park page)*" and a **STOP TALK** button that ends it. Afterwards it shows who talked last, when, and for how long.

Lock the Park page from the studio

1. Open **Monitors** → **Master Output**. Under **Station Monitors**, find the station's strip.
2. Set **Park page control** to **OFF**.

While it is OFF, every Park page shows "*Controls locked by the studio*": the fader, MUTE, carts, closing time and Tap to Talk are locked. Listen still works. Only Ether can set it back to **ON**.

Good to know

- **The studio computer must be on and connected for changes.** The closing time, sound, MUTE, carts and talk are sent to the computer that is playing the station. If that computer is offline, the change is not sent and the phone says so; it is not held for later.
- **Carts fire on the station that is open on screen in Ether.** If the station is not the one showing on that computer, the cart does not fire.
- **What the page shows is what the station reports.** After a change, the page shows the new value once the station confirms it (usually within a few seconds).
- "*This station isn't reporting.*" — the page loaded, but the studio computer isn't sending anything. It fills in once that computer is running Ether.
- "*Can't reach the station right now.*" — the phone couldn't reach the page's server. It keeps trying and shows the last update.
- "*No park at this address.*" — the address doesn't match a station's public page. Check the link.
- Microphone blocked: the page shows the steps for iPhone or Android to allow the microphone, then reload.
- The Park page cannot start, stop or change the music log, and cannot take the station off air.

17. Jukebox

What it's for

The Jukebox is a public request wall. It opens as its own window that you put on a screen the public can see. It shows a wall of album covers. A guest taps a cover, types their name, and the song joins a queue on the right of the screen with their name and their place in line. Guests can also scan a QR code and request from their phone. The jukebox plays through a source channel on your board, like a microphone: it is on air only when that channel is on and its fader is up. It never adds anything to your station's log, never changes your clocks or rotation, and never touches your station's AUTO/MANUAL. It plays music only: no spots, no traffic.

Where to find it

- **Set it up:** Settings → **Jukebox**.
- **Open the display:** ☰ menu (top right) → **Jukebox**.
- **Put it on the board:** the source dropdown at the top of a source channel (D, E, F or S1–S5) → **Jukebox**.
- **Phone and lobby addresses:** Settings → **Links**, under the jukebox entries (**Jukebox request page**, **Lobby screen**).

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network.

1. Choose the music the public can pick

1. Open **Settings** → **Jukebox**.
2. You see every category on this station, with the number of songs in each that the jukebox can play.
3. Tick the categories you are happy for the public to choose from. Each tick saves straight away. There is no Save button for the ticks. A line under the list confirms **Saved.**
4. Under the list, **Pool:** shows the real total, for example "Pool: 1,284 songs across 4 categories."

- A category showing **no playable songs** has nothing the jukebox can use. Ticking it adds nothing.
- Only music counts. Songs with no file on this computer are left out on purpose, so a public pick can never produce dead air.
- If the station has no categories yet, the screen tells you to create them first and come back.

2. Name your request page (the QR code)

1. In **Settings** → **Jukebox**, find **Request link (QR)**.
2. Type a short name, for example `party`. Use lowercase letters, numbers and dashes, and start with a letter or number.
3. Press **Save**. The line below says **Request link saved.**
4. The Jukebox window turns the name into an address (for example `listen.ether-technologies.com/jukebox/party`) and shows it as a large QR code under the queue, with the words **Request from your phone**.

- Leave the box empty and the Jukebox shows no code. It says **No request link set yet** instead.

- Type a name, not a web address. The box also accepts a full `https://` address and puts it in the QR code as typed, but the phone request page described in section 6 only works with a short name.

3. Set the request limits

1. In **Settings** → **Jukebox**, find **Request limits**.
2. **Max waiting** — how many requests may wait at once. Default 12. Allowed 1 to 500.
3. **Repeat after … minutes** — how long before the same song can be requested again. Default 60. Allowed 0 to 1440. Set **0** to allow a song straight back.
4. Press **Save**. The line below says **Request limits saved.**

These rules apply to requests typed at the Jukebox window and to requests from phones alike. The repeat window counts any play of the song on this computer, including a play from your normal log, not only jukebox plays.

4. Put the jukebox on the board

1. On the board, go to a source channel: D, E, F or S1–S5.
2. Open the source dropdown at the top of the channel and choose **Jukebox**.
3. Make sure the channel is **ON** and bring the fader up when you want it heard.

- Decks A, B and C cannot be a jukebox. Automation runs those decks, so the jukebox never shares a deck with your log.
- Use one jukebox channel. If more than one channel is set to Jukebox, the jukebox plays on the first one (in channel order).
- You can change the patch while the Jukebox window is open. The window notices within a few seconds.

5. Open and run the display

1. Click the ☰ **menu** at the top right → **Jukebox**.
2. It opens in its own window, fullscreen. Drag it to the screen the public will see.

What the public sees:

- **NOW PLAYING** across the top: the cover, then the requester's name, the song title and the artist. When nothing is playing it says **Nothing playing — pick a song below.**
- **Search by song or artist…** under it. The wall narrows as you type. There is no button to press.
- **The wall of covers.** Scroll to see more; more covers load as you go. Covers come from the artwork inside your music files and from the iTunes catalogue. A cover with no artwork yet shows a coloured tile with the song title.
- **THE QUEUE** on the right, with the number of requests waiting. ● **UP NEXT** is at the top: the next waiting request, or, if nobody is waiting and AUTO is on, the song the jukebox has already chosen. Behind it, **AFTER THAT** lists everyone else, numbered #2, #3, #4… in the order they asked.
- Every entry shows three lines: the person's name, the song title, the artist. When the jukebox picked the song itself, the name reads **Unknown**.
- The QR code at the bottom right.

To request a song at the screen:

1. Tap a cover.
2. Type a name in **Your name** (up to 40 characters).
3. Press **PLAY NEXT** (or press Enter). Press **Cancel** to go back.
4. A message thanks the person and says the song is in the queue or up next.

How requests play:

- Requests play in the order they arrived. A request never cuts a song that is already playing; it starts when the current song ends.
- **One song at a time per person.** Someone with a request still waiting is told *You already have "…" waiting. You can pick another once it has played.*
- A song that is already on the list cannot be added again: *"…" is already on the list.*
- A song that played recently is refused with roughly how many minutes to wait.
- When the queue is full: *The queue is full right now — 12 songs are already waiting. Try again shortly.*
- If a requested song cannot be played, the jukebox says *Couldn't play "…" — skipping to the next request.* and moves on.

The OPERATOR button

The small **OPERATOR** button at the right of the NOW PLAYING strip holds the controls the public should not see. Click it to open or close them.

- It reads **ON AIR** with a flashing red dot when the jukebox deck is playing, its channel is ON and its fader is up. All three are needed.
- Its border and dot turn amber when something needs attention: not routed to a channel, channel OFF, or fader down.
- Inside, a line tells you the routing state, for example *Routed to Deck D · channel ON · AUTO on…*, or what is wrong: not routed, channel OFF, or fader down. Requests keep being collected in every case.
- **AUTO ON / AUTO OFF** is the jukebox's own AUTO. It has nothing to do with your station's AUTO/MANUAL. It starts **OFF** each time the window opens.
  - **AUTO ON** — between requests the jukebox keeps music going, shuffled from the categories you ticked.
  - **AUTO OFF** — only requested songs play. When the queue is empty the jukebox is silent, on purpose.
- Next to AUTO: the number of songs in the pool and the names of the ticked categories.

6. Requests from phones

When a short name is saved in **Request link (QR)** and categories are ticked, Ether publishes the pool to your request page. A guest who scans the QR code:

1. Sees **REQUEST A SONG** and your station name.
2. Types a name in **YOUR NAME**.
3. Searches in **PICK A SONG** and taps a song (a tick appears).
4. Presses the button at the bottom, which reads **Request "…"**.
5. Sees *You're in the queue!* and *Watch the screen — your name will appear in the queue.* **Request another** starts again.

- Phone requests follow the same rules as the screen (one at a time, max waiting, repeat window). The phone cannot always be told when a rule refuses a request, which is why the page says "watch the screen."
- If this computer is offline, the page says the request is saved and will join the queue when the booth is back.
- Changes to the ticked categories reach the phone page within about a minute.
- If the name does not match a published jukebox, the phone shows **This jukebox isn't set up yet**.

7. The lobby screen (optional)

A second, read-only screen for a room, showing **NOW PLAYING**, **COMING UP** and the QR code. Find its address in **Settings** → **Links** → **Lobby screen** (it is your request address with `/lobby` on the end) and open it in a browser on any screen. It updates only while the Jukebox window is open on this computer.

Moving and closing the window

- **Escape** leaves fullscreen so you get the normal window bar back. **F11** goes back to fullscreen. Escape never stops audio and never closes the window.
- Close the window like any window. Closing it does not stop your station.

Good to know

- **The jukebox plays to one station: the active one.** With no active station it shows **No station selected** and does nothing. Sign in, pick a station in the main window, then reopen the Jukebox.
- **The jukebox isn't set up yet** means no categories are ticked. Go to Settings → Jukebox.
- **No songs available to pick** with categories ticked means the ticked categories have no songs whose files are on this computer.
- **The song list couldn't be loaded** is a fault, not an empty library. Check the log.
- Ticks you change in Settings show on an open Jukebox window within a few seconds; you do not need to reopen it.
- Jukebox songs are written to Play History like any other play, marked as jukebox plays.
- There is no priority and no paying to skip the line. Requests are first come, first served.

18. Screens

What it's for

A screen is a window you lay out yourself from Ether's own panels — **Carts**, **Program Log** and **Song Library** — side by side, stacked, or as tabs, at the sizes you want. You save it under a name and open it again whenever you need it. Typical screens: two cart walls and the log for a live show; the library and the log for building the day; carts and the library on a second monitor.

The panels are the real ones, not copies. A cart fired from your screen plays exactly as from the Carts window, and an edit in your screen's Program Log is the same log as everywhere else.

Where to find it

☰ **menu** → **Screens.** It opens a new, empty screen in its own window.

Plan: Local (every plan).

A screen belongs to one station

A screen works on the station that was active when you opened it. The station's name is shown in the screen's top bar. Switching station in the main window does not change an open screen.

Build a screen

1. ☰ **menu** → **Screens.** A new window opens. It is in **EDIT**, and its middle says **An empty screen**.
2. **Add panels.** Press **+ Carts**, **+ Program Log** or **+ Song Library** in the top bar. Each new panel opens beside the last one. You can add the same panel more than once (two cart walls, two logs).
3. **Arrange them:**
   - Drag a panel's tab onto another panel to stack them as tabs.
   - Drag a tab to the edge of a panel to split the space.
   - Drag the line between two panels to resize them.
   - Press × on a tab to remove that panel.
4. **Save.** Press **SAVE** and type a name. After that, **SAVE** updates the same screen. The top bar shows the name (or **Unsaved screen** until you save), and a short message confirms *Saved "name"*.
5. **Lock it.** Press **EDIT**. It changes to **LIVE**: panels can no longer be dragged, resized or closed, and every panel keeps working. Press **LIVE** to go back to EDIT.

Open a saved screen

1. In any screen window, press **OPEN…**.
2. A list shows the screens saved for this station (**Screens on *station***). Pick one.
3. It opens in its own window, in **LIVE**, exactly as you saved it.

NEW SCREEN opens another empty screen window.

Each saved screen remembers where its window was on this computer.

Good to know

- Only **Carts**, **Program Log** and **Song Library** can be placed on a screen.
- Cart keys belong to the cart wall you last clicked (see chapter 9).
- If a screen will not open and says *That screen is not saved on this station.*, it belongs to another station: switch to that station and use **OPEN…** there.
- A saved screen cannot yet be renamed or deleted from the screen window.
- Screens are saved for the station, not per user profile.
- **Plan:** a saved screen's arrangement goes to your other computers through Multi-computer sync, which needs **Live 128, Live 320 or Network**. Without it, screens stay on this computer.

19. Remote Access & Website

What it's for

While Ether is open, it answers other devices **on the same network as this computer** (the same Wi-Fi or office network). Two things are offered:

- **Phone remote**: a page for a phone or tablet. It shows what is playing and what is up next, with ⏭ **Skip**, ■ **Stop all**, **AUTO on** and **AUTO off** for the station you are working on. No app is needed, only the phone's browser.
- **Now playing, on your network**: an address that any page on the same network can read to show the current song, for example a screen in the lobby or a studio sign.

This works only inside your own network. A phone on mobile data, or a public website on the internet, cannot reach it. For your public website, use your station's listener page or the embed player (see "Good to know").

Where to find it

File → Settings → Broadcast → Remote Access & Website.

Plan: Local (every plan). It runs on this computer alone.

Use the phone remote

1. On the computer, open **File → Settings → Broadcast** and go to **Remote Access & Website**.
2. Under **Phone remote**, read the address, for example `http://192.168.1.20:4242`. Press **Copy** if you want to send it to the phone.
3. Make sure the phone is on the same Wi-Fi as this computer.
4. On the phone, open that address in the browser. The page is titled **ETHER REMOTE**.
5. The phone asks you to **Enter the 6-digit code**. Type the code shown next to **Code the phone asks for:** in Settings and tap **Connect**. The phone remembers the code.
6. The phone now shows the station's name, **Now playing** (or **Not playing**), the title and artist, and the next five items under **Up next**. It updates every few seconds.
7. Tap ⏭ **Skip**, ■ **Stop all**, **AUTO on** or **AUTO off**. The phone says **Done.**, or **Not done:** and the reason.

The commands always go to the station you are working on in Ether's main window.

Change the code

1. In Settings, press **New code** next to the code.
2. A new 6-digit code appears. Every phone has to enter the new code. A phone with the old code is sent back to the code box and told *"That code is not right."*

Show what's playing on a page on your network

1. In **Remote Access & Website**, under **Now playing, on your network**, copy the address. It is the phone remote's address followed by `/now-playing.json`.

2. Give it to whoever builds the page or screen. The page can read it every few seconds.

It returns the station's name, the song title, the artist, whether it is playing, and when the song started. No code is needed to read it.

Good to know

- **Same network only.** The address shown is this computer's address on your local network. Phones and pages on other networks cannot reach it.
- **For a public website, use your listener page or the embed player.** See **Settings** → **Broadcast** → **Your listener page** and **Settings** → **Links** (chapter 22).
- **The first time, Windows may ask whether to allow Ether on your network.** Allow it for private networks, or phones cannot reach it. Settings says "*Ether is answering on port 4242*" when Ether is ready.
- **If another program already uses port 4242**, Settings shows "*Not available: …*" in red, and the remote cannot be used.
- **After 5 wrong codes within a minute**, that phone is refused until the minute is up.
- **The commands run in Ether's main window.** If the main window is not open, the phone says so.
- The phone remote works with no internet connection, as long as the phone and this computer share the network.

20. Logs and reports

What it's for

The **Play Log** is the permanent record of what actually aired on this station. From it you can look up any play, see which computer aired it, check spots against what was scheduled, and export the files that royalty societies and advertisers ask for: a standard as-run CSV, BMI and ASCAP files, a printable PDF, a traffic affidavit and an as-run reconciliation. **Listener Analytics** turns the same record into charts: plays per day and per hour, top songs, top artists and time on air by category.

The Play Log is the record. It is not the plan. The plan is the Program Log (see chapter 7).

Where to find it

- **Play Log:** menu **Schedule** → **Play Log**, or the ☰ menu (top right) → **Play Log**. It opens in its own window.
- **Listener Analytics:** menu **Tools** → **Listener Analytics**.

Plan: Local (every plan). Everything in this chapter reads this computer's own records.

1. Look up what aired

1. Open **Schedule** → **Play Log**. The page title reads **Play Log** with the line *What actually aired. Permanent record.*
2. Pick a period with the buttons at the top: **Today**, **7 Days**, **30 Days** or **All**.
3. For an exact range, fill the two date boxes (from → to). You can also fill the two time boxes to narrow it to part of a day. An empty time box means the whole day. Typing a date or time switches the period to a custom range.
4. Three counts sit above the list: **Songs Played**, **Unique Artists** and **Unique Songs**.
5. Each row shows when it aired, the title, artist, deck, category and the computer it aired on (**Aired on**).

Every play in the period is listed. There is no row limit.

2. Narrow the list

These filters work on the **Play Log** view only.

1. **Search title or artist…** — type part of a title or artist name.
2. **All decks** — pick one deck to see only what played on it.
3. **All computers** — pick one computer to see only what it aired. Plays from before computers were recorded show as **Not recorded (before 10-18)**.
4. The element-type filter (music, spots, sweepers and so on) shows a count for each type. Tick the types you want.
5. **Clear** (next to the filters) resets search, deck, computer and type in one go.

The computer filter also applies to the exports below.

3. Export for royalties and records

With the **Play Log** view showing, the export buttons are on the right of the top bar. Each one covers the whole period you picked, not just what is on screen.

- **Export CSV** — the as-run file: start time, end time, duration, date, title, artist, deck, category, advertiser, ISCI, cart number, status and **Aired On**.
- **BMI** — a CSV in BMI's layout: Title, Performer, Date Of Use, Time Of Use, Duration.
- **ASCAP** — a CSV in ASCAP's layout: Title, Artist, Date, Start Time, Duration (min), Source (your station name).
- **PDF** — opens a printable **Traffic Log** page (station name, period, which computer, every play) and starts the print dialog. Choose **Save as PDF** in the print dialog to keep a file.

1. Pick the period (and a computer, if you want only one).
2. Press the export you need.
3. Choose where to save the file.

The BMI and ASCAP files leave out the **Aired On** column so they stay in each society's exact format. The computer filter still applies to them. A play whose length was never recorded has a blank duration rather than a made-up one.

4. Spots against the schedule (Traffic)

1. At the top of the Play Log, press **Traffic** (next to **Play Log**). The title changes to **Traffic**: *Spots scheduled against spots aired.*
2. Four counts sit at the top: **Spots Scheduled**, **Aired**, **Missed** and **Aired of Due** (a percentage; green at 95% and up).
3. The table lists each spot: scheduled time, aired time, the difference in seconds, status (**AIRED**, **MISSED** or pending), cart, ISCI, advertiser, title and length. A difference of more than two minutes shows amber.
4. Press **Export Traffic CSV** for the affidavit. It adds the date, agency and spot type columns.

- If no spots were scheduled in the period, the page says so and tells you how to get spots into the log: add spot breaks to a clock and run **Fill Day** in the Program Log.
- If some spots have no advertiser, cart or ISCI on file, an amber line counts them. They still export, with those columns blank. Fill them in under **Spots & Promos** so the affidavit is billable.

5. As-Run reconciliation

1. Press **As-Run** in the top bar.
2. A panel titled **As-Run Reconciliation** opens. Every item the log scheduled in the period is matched against whether it aired:
   - ✓ **MATCH** — scheduled and aired.
   - ✗ **MISSED** — scheduled and did not air.
   - **+ UNSCHED** — aired but was not in the log.
   - · **PENDING** — still to come.
3. Press **Export As-Run CSV** to save it (time, scheduled title and artist, actual title and artist, status, duration, aired on).
4. Press **Close** to hide the panel.

6. Clear the play log

The red **Clear** button at the end of the top bar erases this station's entire play log after you confirm (*Clear the entire play log?*). This cannot be undone. Export anything you need first.

7. Listener Analytics

1. Open **Tools** → **Listener Analytics**.
2. Pick a range at the top: **7 days**, **30 days**, **90 days** or **All time**.
3. Use the four tabs:
   - **Overview** — **Total Plays**, **Unique Songs**, **Unique Artists** and **Avg/Day**; a **Daily Play Volume** chart; **Plays by Hour of Day**; **Category Breakdown** (share of plays and hours per category); and **Recent Plays**.
   - **Top Songs** — each song's plays, category, BPM, LUFS and when it last played.
   - **Top Artists** — each artist's plays, how many different songs, and when they last played.
   - **Scheduling** — **Peak Broadcast Hours** (the busiest hours of the day) and **Time on Air by Category**.
4. Press ✕ to close.

Good to know

- Listener Analytics counts **plays from this computer's play log**. Despite its name, it does not count listeners.
- The Play Log keeps a record per station. Switch station first to see another station's log.
- The totals at the top of Listener Analytics count music only; spots, sweepers and other elements are left out.
- On a computer used only now and then for playout, the log only holds what that computer aired while it was running.

21. Backups and keeping on air

What it's for

This chapter covers the ways Ether protects your station. **Backups** keep copies of your station's setup (library list, clocks, shows, schedule, settings) on this computer and in the cloud, so you can go back to the copy from just before a mistake. **Keep my stuff synced** keeps your setup and your audio current in the cloud and on every computer signed into your account. **Keep My Station On Air** restarts Ether if it crashes and logs Windows back in after a reboot, so the station returns to air unattended. The **tray icon** keeps Ether playing when its window is closed.

Where to find it

- **Backups and sync: File → Settings → Backup & Restore**.
- **Cloud Log Backup: Tools → Cloud Log Backup**.
- **Keep My Station On Air: File → Settings → System**.
- **Tray icon:** the Ether icon in the Windows system tray (bottom right of the taskbar).

Plan:

- Backups on this computer, Keep My Station On Air and the tray: Local (every plan).
- Cloud backups, **Keep my stuff synced** and **Cloud Log Backup**: Live 128, Live 320 or Network.

1. Backups on this computer (and in the cloud)

In **Settings → Backup & Restore**, find **Backups on this computer**. Each computer has its own settings here.

1. **On this computer** — choose how often this computer saves a backup to its own disk: **Off**, every 5, 10, 15 or 30 minutes, every hour, 2, 6 or 12 hours, or **Every day**.
2. **keep the last** — how many of those backups to keep. The line below shows the last backup, when the next one runs, and roughly how much disk space your setting uses.
3. **In the cloud** — the same choice for backups sent to the cloud.
4. **keep** — how many cloud backups of this computer to keep. **0** keeps all of them.
5. Press **Back up now** on either row to make one straight away.

Each change is saved as you make it. The line under the rows says ✓ **Saved on this computer.**

Your audio files are not part of these backups. Audio goes to the cloud through **Keep my stuff synced** (section 3).

2. Restore a backup

Under **Every backup — pick the one from just before a mistake** you see every backup this computer can use: its own local backups and every cloud backup on your account, from any of your computers. Each row shows the date and time, the computer, where it is kept (**On this computer** or **Cloud**) and its size.

1. Switch **Keep my stuff synced** off first (section 3), so the restore does not spread before you are ready.

2. Find the backup from just before the mistake.
3. Press **Restore** and confirm.
4. When it says it is done, close Ether fully and open it again so everything takes effect.

- A restore replaces this computer's station database. Changes this computer had not yet sent are discarded, and the message tells you how many.
- If you see *sign in to see cloud backups*, only local backups can be listed until you sign in.

Send a restore to every computer

After a restore, an amber card **This computer was restored from a backup** may appear under the sync switch. It means this computer had already sent changes to your other computers since that backup. If you do nothing, switching sync back on brings those changes back here too.

1. Keep sync switched off.
2. Type your 4-digit admin PIN.
3. Press **Send this restore to every machine** and confirm. The confirmation says how many rows go back to the backup's version and how many are removed everywhere.
4. Switch **Keep my stuff synced** back on.

Other computers' own changes are kept unless they changed one of the same rows. Then the backup's version wins.

3. Keep my stuff synced

At the top of **Settings** → **Backup & Restore** is **Keep my stuff synced**: one sentence that says where you stand, and one switch.

1. Read the sentence. For example: *Everything on this computer is in the cloud — your whole setup and all 1,240 audio files, as of 5 minutes ago.* If something is behind, it says so and offers a button such as **Back up now**, **Finish sending** or **Try again**.
2. Use the switch to turn it on or off **for this computer**. The line under it confirms what happened.
3. Leave it on in normal use.

When it is on, your setup is kept current in both directions on every computer signed into your account. **New audio comes down on its own.** Audio you add on this computer goes up when you press **Send just the audio** (below) or the card's **Back up now** / **Finish sending** button.

Advanced

Open **Advanced** under the switch for the manual controls. You don't need them in normal use.

- **Going to the cloud right now** — **ON** or **OFF**, as reported by the backup itself. If the switch says off, this must say **OFF**.
- **Audio transfer** — how often new audio is checked for coming down, when it last checked, and what it pulled.
- **Your audio files** — how many of your audio files are in the cloud and how many are still to send.
- **WHERE YOUR AUDIO LIVES** — your catalogue folder. Press **Change folder** to pick another.
- **Send just the audio** — sends the audio files that are not in the cloud yet. **Stop** cancels it. Tick **Re-send every file, even ones already uploaded** to send everything again.

- **Having trouble? Check connection** — checks that this computer can reach the cloud.
- **Cloud audio cleanup** — **Release cloud audio now** removes from the cloud the audio of songs deleted long enough ago, after checking no live song uses the file and nothing scheduled needs it. It needs your 4-digit admin PIN. It never runs on its own.

Advanced — sync diagnostics

Lower on the same tab, **Advanced — sync diagnostics** shows this computer, your stations' identities, how many changes are waiting to sync, and the sync engine's status.

- **PREFLIGHT** — refresh the readings.
- **PUSH NOW** — send this computer's waiting changes now.
- **PULL NOW** — fetch changes from your other computers now.
- **CLEAR PENDING…** — throw away this computer's waiting changes and start fresh from now. You must type **CLEAR** to confirm. No songs, stations, clocks, logs or settings are deleted, but it cannot be undone.

Before switching sync on for a second computer, compare the station identities shown here with that computer's. If they do not match, the two installs will not merge cleanly.

4. Cloud Log Backup

Tools → Cloud Log Backup is a second screen for cloud backups.

1. **Backup to R2 Now** — makes a full backup of this station's setup in the cloud straight away. **Recent Backups** below it lists the last five, with time, size and a check code.
2. **Catalogue → Cloud** — **Back Up Catalogue to Cloud** sends every audio file in your catalogue folder (songs, carts, spots, announcements, sweepers, voice tracks). Files already in the cloud are skipped.
3. **Install Station from Cloud** — on a **new** computer, press **Install Station from Cloud** to pull your whole station down: first the database, then the audio. It replaces the local database. If this computer already has songs of its own, Ether shows the date of the cloud backup and asks again before replacing anything. When it finishes, restart Ether.
4. **Connection** — **Account** shows **Uses this computer's sign-in**, and **Station ID (your email)** fills in by itself. Press **Connect** to list **Saved Backups**.
5. **Create Backup** — **Backup Now** makes the same full backup as step 1.
6. **Saved Backups** — backups kept by older versions of Ether. Press ✕ on a row to delete it.

5. Keep My Station On Air

On Windows, Ether can restart itself after a crash and log Windows back in after a reboot.

1. Open **File → Settings → System** and find **Keep My Station On Air**.
2. Turn on **Enable auto-recovery after reboot**.
3. Type the Windows password for the account shown, then press **Enable**.
4. Windows asks for permission once. Allow it.
5. Three status lines show the result: **Automatic logon** (Configured), **Startup task** (Registered) and **Watchdog** (Running).

- **Repair** — re-enter the password and apply the setup again, if a status line is not green.

- **Disable** — removes automatic logon and the startup task and stops the watchdog.
- If Ether keeps crashing and restarting, a red line says **Crash-loop alarm tripped — see Station Health.** See chapter 23.

The password is used once and kept in Windows' own encrypted store. Ether does not save it. **Warning (shown on screen):** anyone who reboots this PC will then land in your logged-in Windows session without a password.

On a Mac this section says *Automatic recovery is available on Windows only.*

6. Closing the window and the tray icon

When you close Ether's main window, it asks what you want:

- **Keep Playing in Tray** — the window closes and audio keeps going. Ether stays in the system tray.
- **Stop & Quit Ether** — stops automation and the stream, shuts the audio engine down and exits. It won't restart by itself.
- **Cancel** — nothing changes.

If the tray icon could not be created on this computer, the dialog offers only **Stop & Quit Ether** and **Cancel**, so Ether is never left playing with nothing to click.

The tray icon:

- Click it to show or hide the Ether window.
- Right-click it for the menu:
  - **Show Ether** — bring the window back.
  - **Stop Keeping On Air…** — stops the on-air watchdog for this session, so Ether won't relaunch if it closes or is force-closed. Useful when you need to shut the computer down fully. Opening Ether again restores it.
  - **Quit Ether** — the same full stop as **Stop & Quit Ether**.

File → Quit Ether (Ctrl+Q) does the same full stop.

Good to know

- Backups cover your station's setup, not your audio files. Audio is protected by sending it to the cloud.
- A restore always needs a restart of Ether to take full effect.
- Restoring and sending a restore expect sync to be **off**. Switch it back on afterwards.
- Closing the window is not quitting. To update Ether or fully stop it, use **Quit Ether**.

22. Station settings

What it's for

This chapter covers the settings that describe your station and your account on this computer: the station's name, timezone and logo, the user profiles, the public addresses of your pages, the outside services Ether can use, and the system-level options. It also covers the **Station Manager**, where you add, edit, publish and delete stations, and the station switcher in the bottom bar.

A station is a whole context you switch into. Each station has its own library associations, clocks, logs and settings.

Where to find it

- **Settings: File** → **Settings**, then the tabs down the left side: **Station**, **Integrations**, **Links** and **System**. (The **Backup & Restore** tab is in chapter 21. Most of **Audio**, **Audio Devices** and **Broadcast** is in chapter 14; this chapter adds **Song Analysis** under **Audio**, and points to chapter 19 for **Remote Access & Website** under **Broadcast**.)
- **Station Manager: Tools** → **Station Manager**, or the station name button in the bottom bar → **Manage Stations…**.
- **Switch station:** the station name button in the bottom bar (green dot and the station's name).

Plan:

- Station, Integrations, System, Song Analysis, Remote Access & Website, switching, editing and deleting stations: Local (every plan).
- The public listener page, the account hub and the **Links** list: Local (every plan). (Some pages listed under Links belong to Station-plan features: the jukebox request page and lobby screen, and the Park page.)
- **Accounts You Can Access:** Live 128, Live 320 or Network.
- **+ Add Station** (registers a new station with your account): not in the price list.

1. Settings → Station

Your Station

1. **Station name** — type the name and press **Save**. It shows in the header and the window title. The button reads **Saved!** for a moment.
2. **Timezone** — pick from the list. It is used for scheduling, play logs and daylight-saving changes. It saves as soon as you pick.
3. **Start Ether automatically when Windows boots** — turn on for a station that runs around the clock.

Public Listener Page

A branded page your listeners can open and install: logo, colours, now-playing and links. The page itself is described in chapter 26.

Send an Invite

Makes an invite file for a new operator.

1. Type the operator's name and initials (up to three letters).
2. Optionally type a personal note. It is shown on their first shift screen.
3. Press **Generate Invite File** and save the file.
4. Put the file next to the Ether installer on their computer.

On first launch Ether reads the file, creates that operator's profile with your note, and renames the file so it is never used twice. The operator still signs in to the account first.

Station Identity

Upload a station logo (PNG, JPG or SVG). It is shown on the On-Shift welcome screen. **Remove** takes it away.

Users & Security

The profiles people pick when they start a shift.

1. **+ Add User** — type a **Name**, pick a role (**Administrator**, **On-Air Jock** or **Music Director**), pick a colour, and optionally a 4-digit PIN. Press **Create User**.
2. **Set PIN** / **Change PIN** — type the new PIN twice and press **Save PIN**. Leave it blank to remove it.
3. **Remove PIN** — the profile can then start a shift without a PIN.
4. **Edit** — change the name, role or colour, then press **Save**.
5. **Delete** — removes the profile after you confirm.

A profile's role is a label. Today it does not restrict what that profile can do in Ether. Some actions in Ether ask for an **admin PIN**: the PIN of an Administrator profile.

Manage Stations

A list of this account's stations on this computer, each with a **Delete** button.

1. Press **Delete** next to the station.
2. Type your 4-digit admin PIN (if an Administrator has a PIN set).
3. Press **Delete Station**.

The station on air can't be deleted here. Switch to another station first.

2. Station Manager

Open **Tools** → **Station Manager**. The header shows how many stations you have and which one is active. The table lists each station: name (with call sign, frequency and city), when it was created, its song and clock counts, and actions.

Add a station

1. Press **+ Add Station**.
2. Fill in **Station Name** (required), and if you like **Callsign**, **Frequency** and **City**.

3. Under **ICECAST**, fill in your own server: **Server URL**, **Mount**, **Password**, **Bitrate** and **Format** (MP3, AAC or OGG).
4. Under **Rotation engine**, leave **Mode** on **Clock-driven (default)** unless you know you want goal-driven rotation. The screen explains the difference.
5. Press **Create Station**.

The station is registered with your account first, then created on this computer. You need to be signed in. If the account's limit is reached or the backend can't be reached, the editor shows why and nothing is created.

Edit a station

Press **Rename** on its row. The same editor opens with all its fields. Change what you need and press **Save Changes**.

Publish a station's listener page

Press **Publish** on its row. The public page editor opens under the row (see chapter 26). A station that has been published shows ● **PUBLISHED** next to its name. **Close** folds the editor away.

Your account hub

Under the header, the **Hub** row sets your account's public page: a logo (**+ Logo**), a **Hub name** and a **handle** (the address `listen.ether-technologies.com/@handle`). Ether checks the handle as you type (✓ **available**, **taken** or **invalid**). Press **Save**. If asked, type your account password.

Delete a station

1. Press **Delete** on its row and confirm.
2. If it is the station on air, Ether switches to another station first.

You can't delete your only station. Create its replacement first, then delete it.

3. Switch station

1. In the bottom bar, click the station name button.
2. The list shows your stations. The active one has a tick.
3. Click another station to switch to it.

The same list has **New Station…** (a quick form with name, call sign and Icecast settings) and **Manage Stations…** (opens the Station Manager).

If your sign-in also gives you access to stations in other accounts, they are listed under **ACCESSIBLE VIA YOUR ACCOUNT**, marked **view-only**. You can see them but not switch to them.

4. Settings → Links

Every public page of your account and stations, at its real address. One section per kind of page:

- **Station player** — each station's public listening page.
- **Embed player** — the player alone, for your own website.

- **Account page** — your account's page listing its stations.
- **Jukebox and lobby** — the request page the jukebox QR code opens, and the lobby screen.
- **Park page** — park staff's page for each station.
- **Sign-up and account** — sign up, log in and account pages.
- **Apps** — the web apps.
- **Website and downloads** — the Ether website and the installers.

Each line shows the page's name and address, with **Open** (opens it in your browser) and **Copy** (copies the address). A line with no address says why, for example a station that has no public name yet. If the addresses can't be read, press **Try again**.

5. Settings → Audio: Song Analysis (loudness and BPM)

This section measures each song's loudness (LUFS) and tempo (BPM) and saves them with the song. **It does not change how loud songs play.** Playback loudness is set by the **Loudness target** in **Loudness & faders**, higher up on the same tab (chapter 14).

1. Open **File** → **Settings** → **Audio** and go to **Song Analysis (loudness and BPM)**.
2. Three boxes show **Analyzed** (how many of all songs), **Average loudness** and **Still to analyze**.
3. Press **Analyze all songs**. It measures every song whose loudness or tempo has not been measured yet. The button reads **Analyzing...** and a line shows the song being measured, with a progress bar.
4. When it finishes, the line says how many songs were analyzed, for example *"Done. Analyzed 412 songs."* If some could not be read, it adds how many, and says they were left unchanged.

Reset clears the saved loudness measurements, so the next **Analyze all songs** measures again. It asks no question first, and it clears them for every song in the library on this computer, not only this station's.

6. Settings → Broadcast: Remote Access & Website

Control the station from a phone on this computer's network, and read what is playing from a page on the same network. See chapter 19, *Remote Access & Website*.

7. Settings → Integrations

Outside services Ether can use. Each needs your own key from that service.

- **Active AI Provider** — choose **Claude (Anthropic)**, **ChatGPT (OpenAI)** or **Gemini (Google)** to power the Desk (☰ menu → **Desk**). A green dot means that provider has a key.
- **Anthropic (Claude)**, **OpenAI (ChatGPT)**, **Google (Gemini)** — paste the key and press **Connect**. Each card shows **Connected** or **Not connected**.
- **Weather — OpenWeatherMap** — paste a free key from openweathermap.org and press **Connect**. It powers the Weather button in the Desk with current Las Vegas conditions. **Disconnect** removes it.
- **Spotify Integration** — your Spotify Developer **Client ID** and **Client Secret**, used by the Spotify import in the Library.
- **Musixmatch Lyrics Scanner** — a Musixmatch API key. Ether scans imported lyrics for red flags (violence, explicit language, hate speech, political content) and shows flags in amber for you to review.
- **Discogs Metadata** — a Discogs **Consumer Key** and **Consumer Secret**, used by the Library's Edit Metadata dialog to look up title, artist, album, year and genre.

8. Settings → System

- **Keep My Station On Air** — automatic restart and Windows logon. See chapter 21.
- **Accounts You Can Access** — appears only if your sign-in gives you access to other accounts. It lists each account, your position in it, and its stations marked **can edit** or **read-only**. It is a list only; you can't operate those stations from here.
- **Factory reset this computer** — erases this account's data on this computer (stations, library, schedule, users and settings) and closes Ether completely. Reopen Ether to sign in again. Other accounts on this computer, and this account on your other computers, are not touched.
  1. Press **Factory reset…**.
  2. Type your account email twice (or **RESET** twice, if no email is shown).
  3. Press **Erase & close Ether**.

Good to know

- Multi-computer sync is set in **Settings** → **Backup & Restore** → **Keep my stuff synced** (chapter 21).
- The quick **New Station…** form in the bottom-bar list creates the station on this computer only. To register a station with your account so it can be published, use **+ Add Station** in the Station Manager.
- **Settings** → **Station** → **Manage Stations** will not delete the station on air; the Station Manager will, by switching away first.
- A factory reset cannot be undone. Make sure your setup is backed up to the cloud first.

23. Health Monitor and System Health

What it's for

The **Health Monitor** is the one screen that answers "is my station OK right now?". It gathers what Ether measures — how much log is left, what the audio is doing, whether rotation hits its targets, whether breaks fire on time, whether the crash watchdog is running — and puts it in one place. Readings are measured, not assumed. If something has not been measured, the panel says so instead of showing green.

System Health and **Station Health** are the same screen, reached from different menus. **Station Health** opens it in its own window, for a wall display.

Where to find it

- ☰ menu (top right) → **Health Monitor**.
- Menu **Tools** → **System Health**.
- Menu **Tools** → **Monitors** → **Station Health** (its own window).
- The two status lights in the bottom bar. Click either one to open the Health Monitor:
  - The **system light** — hover it for *All systems normal*, *Warning*, *System error* or *HA alarm — auto-restart halted*.
  - The **catalogue light** — **CATALOGUE OK** when every audio file resolves on this computer. Hover it for the cause when it is not.

Plan: Local (every plan).

1. Open it and pick a view

1. Open the Health Monitor. The header shows how long Ether has been running and that the live readings update every second.
2. Press **WALL VIEW** for a fixed, read-only layout that fits any screen without scrolling. It is made for a studio wall. Press **OPS VIEW** to go back to every panel and control.
3. **Station Health** (the small pop-out button in the header) opens the same screen in its own window. Full-screen that window on a wall display.
4. ✕ closes it.

In **OPS VIEW**, the right-hand column is the **live activity** terminal: what Ether is doing, line by line. In **WALL VIEW** it is a thin **LIVE ACTIVITY** rail; click it to expand, and **LIVE ACTIVITY — MINIMISE** to fold it back.

2. At a glance

Three cards across the top:

- **Runway** — how many days of log this station has left before it runs out.
- **Rotation health** — your rotation goals against what the clocks actually call.
- **Queue** — how many items wait behind what is on air.

Below them: **Runway trend** (the last 7 days, so you see it falling before it becomes a problem), audio levels, rotation goals per category, and **Live events** — the health ledger, newest first.

3. Alerts

Right under the cards is the **Alerts** list: every alert this station raised, newest first. It is never collapsed or filtered. Tick **every station** to see alerts from all your stations.

Alerts include a log row that aired twice, a log row changed after it aired, something that aired but could not be recorded, and a row that aired after it was marked missed.

The list only reports. Nothing in it fixes or silences anything.

4. The detail panels

Below the alerts, the panels are yours to arrange: drag a panel by its header to move it, and collapse the ones you don't need today. Ether remembers the order.

- **Audio Processing** — the loudness chain: loudness in and out, the level before and after, the ride gain and the limiter.
- **Mic Inputs** — whether each mic input is working. **Patch…** takes you to the settings.
- **Remote Link** — the state of a remote broadcast link.
- **Account sign-in** — the state of this computer's account sign-in.
- **PFL Output** — whether the headphone (cue) output is really playing. **Change…** takes you to the settings.
- **Spot Schedule — this hour & next** — where your breaks fall. Hollow markers are still to come, solid ones have aired. A break that is going to be late turns amber before it misses.
- **Core Systems** — **Audio Engine**, **Playout mode**, **Database**, **Schema**, **Dead Air Protection** and **Queue**.
- **High Availability** — **Watchdog Process**, **Supervising This App**, **Startup Task**, **Mutual Supervision**, **Crash-Loop Alarm**, **Process Uptime**, **Audio Output**, **Sync Engine**, **Memory (RSS)** and event-loop lag.
- **Recent Events** — the watchdog's log. **Last Error** shows the most recent error, with **Dismiss**.
- **Library & Rotation** — per station: schedule runway, sweepers, whether audio files are on this computer, the rotation pool, items skipped at load, prefetch lag, rotation depth and goals, and the last Generate. When the last Generate had to bend the rules, a **Last Generate** row appears (see "Slots where a rule was broken" below).
- **Sync changes held** — changes the sync is holding back.
- **Spots that did not air** — breaks that were due and did not play. **RELOAD** reads it again; it changes nothing.
- **Playout & Generate** — the log reader and the last log build.
- **DMCA Play Log Export** — exports the play log as a CSV file (see below). It also shows how many entries the play log holds and when the last one played.

5. Things you can do from here

Clear a crash-loop alarm

If Ether crashed and restarted too many times in a row, the watchdog stops restarting it and the **Crash-Loop Alarm** row turns red.

1. Fix or note the cause (see **Recent Events** and the live activity).
2. In **High Availability**, press **CLEAR & RE-SUPERVISE** on the **Crash-Loop Alarm** row. It removes the alarm, stops the halted watchdog and starts one that looks after the running app again.

Push or pull sync now

On the **Sync Engine** row in **High Availability**, **PUSH** sends this computer's waiting changes now and **PULL** fetches changes from your other computers now. These are manual overrides.

Fix files outside the catalogue

At the top of **Library & Rotation**, the **Catalogue** box checks that every audio file sits in your catalogue folder. A file stored elsewhere may play here but will not reach your other computers.

1. Press **SCAN CATALOGUE**. Scanning changes nothing. It reports what it found.
2. If items need fixing, a second button names the work, for example **FIX 12 ITEMS**. Press it to move or relink them.
3. The health figures refresh on the next check.

Slots where a rule was broken

When Generate builds the log and no song can meet a **STRICT** music rule, it breaks that rule only as the last resort and puts in the category's least recently played song. A STRICT **Max songs in a row** that cannot be met is marked the same way. Those slots are marked on the log row (see the Program Log chapter) and counted here.

1. Open **Library & Rotation** and find the station.
2. If the last Generate broke a rule, a **Last Generate** row shows **separation relaxed ×** and the number of slots.
3. The line under it names up to three categories with the most such slots, for example "*Gold ×4 · Recurrents ×2*".

If a category had no songs at all, the row instead shows how many categories were empty, in red, and names them.

Export the play log (CSV)

1. In **DMCA Play Log Export**, press **Export Play Log CSV**.
2. A Save window opens. Pick a folder and a file name (it suggests one with today's date) and press **Save**.
3. The button shows **✓ Saved** when the file is written.

- The file has one row per played item, newest first: date, time, title, artist, deck and a timestamp. It holds up to the last 10,000 plays recorded on this computer, from every station on it.
- If you press **Cancel** in the Save window, nothing is written.
- If the file cannot be written, a red line says "*Play log not exported:*" and the reason.

See which songs can't be played

When **Library & Rotation** shows songs whose audio is not on this computer, press **show unresolvable list** under that station to see them, so you can find and fix each one. **hide unresolvable list** folds it away.

Good to know

- The same screen opens from all three menus.
- The Health Monitor reports. Apart from the buttons named in this chapter, it changes nothing. **Export Play Log CSV** only writes a file; it does not change the play log.
- A grey reading means "not measured yet", not "fine".

24. Keyboard shortcuts, Help and About

What it's for

This chapter lists the keys that work in Ether and explains the **Help** menu: the shortcut list, the documentation, checking for updates, and the About screen.

Where to find it

- **The shortcut list: Help → Keyboard Shortcuts**, or press **Shift + ?** on the main screen.
- **Help menu:** the menu bar at the top of the window → **Help**.

Plan: Local (every plan). Updates are included in every plan.

Keyboard shortcuts

Ether's shortcuts are **single keys**: press the key on its own. Click somewhere that is **not a text box** first; while you are typing in a box, the keys type.

On the main screen

Key	What it does
A	Turns AUTO on or off (the same as clicking the AUTO / MANUAL button).
L	Opens the Library.
S	Opens Schedule (Clocks).
G	Opens the Play Log.
Shift + ?	Shows or hides the shortcut list.
Esc	Closes the shortcut list and the ☰ menu. Esc never stops audio.

On a cart wall

Keys	What they do
1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8	Fire carts 1 to 8.
Q W E R T Y U I	Fire carts 9 to 16.
A S D F G H J K	Fire carts 17 to 24.

Only carts that have audio on them fire. Carts after the 24th are click-only. If more than one cart wall is showing in the same window, the keys belong to the wall you clicked last.

While a cart wall is open, these keys fire carts only. That includes the cart wall under the board (the **CARTS** tab) and a deck slot set to a cart wall. **A**, **S** and **G** then fire carts 17, 18 and 21; they do not switch AUTO, open Clocks or open the Play Log.

In the Cue Editor

The letter keys work when nothing in the editor has the focus, for example right after it opens. After you click the waveform, a button or a box, they do nothing until you click an empty part of the editor outside the waveform. **Space** also works after you click the waveform.

Key	What it does
Space	Plays or pauses.
I	Jumps to **CUE IN**.
N	Jumps to **INTRO END**.
O	Jumps to **OUTRO START**.
U	Jumps to **CUE OUT**.

The four letters are shown on the cue-point strip. A jump is the same as clicking that point: if the song was playing, it keeps playing from there.

On the profile screen

While entering a PIN: the number keys type the PIN, **Backspace** deletes a digit, and **Esc** goes back to the list of profiles.

On a fader

Click a fader first. The **arrow keys** step it up or down, and **Enter** lets you type a level.

Menu shortcuts

Keys	What they do
Ctrl + N (⌘ + N on Mac)	**File** → **New Session**: returns to the main screen.
Ctrl + Q (⌘ + Q)	**File** → **Quit Ether**: stops the audio engine and closes Ether completely.
Ctrl + R (⌘ + R)	**View** → **Reload**: reloads the window. You stay signed in while Ether runs; the window comes straight back without the sign-in screen.
F12	**View** → **Toggle DevTools**: developer tools, for troubleshooting with support.

Ctrl, Alt and Cmd

A single-key shortcut held with Ctrl, Alt or Cmd (⌘) is not a shortcut. It does nothing. Ctrl + S does not open Clocks, Ctrl + A does not switch AUTO, and Ctrl + 1 does not fire a cart. A habit from another program can never change what is on air. **Shift** is different: Shift + ? opens the shortcut list.

Help menu

Help → Keyboard Shortcuts

Opens the shortcut list, the same as pressing **Shift + ?**. Press **Esc**, ✕, or click outside it to close.

The list is titled **Keyboard Shortcuts**. It shows only keys that work:

- **Navigation: L** Library, **S** Schedule / Clocks, **G** Play Log, **A** Toggle Automation.
- **Interface: Shift + ?** shows or hides the list, **Esc** closes the list and the ☰ menu, **1–8, Q–I, A–K** fire carts 1 to 24 while the cart wall is open, and **Ctrl / Alt / ⌘ + key** is not a shortcut.
- It also reminds you that Theme Studio is in the ≡ menu.

Help → Documentation

Opens the documentation in your web browser.

Help → Check for Updates

Asks whether a newer version of Ether is available. It always answers. A short message at the top of the window says "*Checking for updates…*", then:

- **If there is one,** a card appears at the bottom-right: **Ether** *(version)* **is ready**. Press **Update Now**, wait for **Update downloaded**, then press **Restart & Update**. Then close Ether completely and open it again, so the audio engine updates too (see *Getting started*). If you pressed **Later** earlier, Check for Updates brings the card back.
- **If you are up to date,** the message says "*Ether (version) is up to date.*"
- **If Ether could not check** (for example, no internet), the message says "*Couldn't check for updates:*" and the reason.

Ether also checks by itself about 10 seconds after it starts and every 30 minutes while it runs. Those checks stay silent unless there is an update.

What's in an update (Details)

Every stage of the update card has a **Details** button: when the update is offered, while it downloads, when it is ready to restart, and if it failed.

1. Press **Details**. A popup lists what was added and fixed, from the release notes published with each version.
2. If you are skipping versions, it shows the notes for every version between yours and the new one, newest first.
3. Close it with **×** or by clicking outside it. The update card is still there.

The notes load only when you press Details, so they never hold up the update. If they cannot be loaded (no internet, or no answer within 8 seconds), or the new version has no published notes, the popup says so.

Help → About Ether

Opens the About screen.

- The top shows the version you are running (for example **v4.6.69**). Quote this number when you report a problem.
- **About** — a short description, and **Contact & Support** links: **Support** and **Legal & Licensing** open an email to Ether, and **GitHub Repository** opens the project page in your browser. The line at the bottom gives the copyright and points to the Open Source tab.

- **What's New** — the release notes published for the version you are running. If none were published, it says "*No published release notes were found for Ether (version).*" If they cannot be loaded, it says why.
- **Open Source** — the open-source software Ether is built with, and their licences.

Press **Close**, ✕, or click outside the screen to close it.

Good to know

- **No key starts, pauses or resumes a deck.** The board's **ON** button is the only way.
- **With a cart wall open, A, S and G belong to the carts.** To switch AUTO or open Clocks or the Play Log from the keyboard, close the cart wall first, or click the button instead.
- **F12 opens developer tools**, not the shortcut list. The shortcut list is **Shift + ?**.

25. The web dashboard (Control Center)

What it's for

The web dashboard lets you watch and run your stations from any web browser, on any computer or phone, without sitting at the studio machine. You see what is on air on each deck, what is coming up, and whether the station is live, stalled or offline. You can skip, stop, start automation, put a station on or off the air, move the broadcast to another computer, edit categories, clocks and dayparts, browse and edit the library, upload new songs, and read your listener, playout and advertiser reports. Edits you make here are sent to the station's own computer running Ether, which applies them and sends the result back.

Where to find it

Open **app.ether-cast.com** in a web browser and sign in. The dashboard calls itself **EtherCast Remote** in its top bar.

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network (Control Center). Individual parts are listed with their own plan below.

Signing in

There are two ways in, both on the same sign-in screen.

As the account owner (email and password)

1. Type the **Email** and **Password** you use to sign in to Ether on the desktop.
2. Press **Sign in**.

As a team member (account email, username and PIN)

1. Press **Team member? Sign in with a username + PIN**.
2. Type the station account's **Account email**, your **Username** (your name in Ether) and your 4-digit **PIN** — the same name and PIN you use at the Ether console.
3. Press **Sign in**. The dashboard remembers the account email on this browser for next time.

Team members are the users made in Ether → **Settings** → **Users & Security**; they appear here by themselves. A few wrong PINs in a row make that browser wait a few minutes before trying again. They never lock your PIN at the Ether console or on the Park page.

To leave, press **Sign out** at the top right. Your name and your role (**Admin** or **User**) show beside it.

Admin and User. The account owner always signs in as an Admin. A team member is an Admin or a User, as set for them in Ether on the desktop. An Admin sees every control described in this chapter. A User can look at everything but does not get the controls, the edit buttons, **Edit settings**, the drag-to-reorder list or the **Users** page.

The top bar

- **Stations** — the list of your stations (the screen you land on).

- **Account** — your account details, your listener hub and billing.
- **Users** — the list of people who can sign in (Admins only).
- The plan name of your account shows under the EtherCast name.

Stations

Each station is a card. The card shows:

- The station name and its call letters and frequency.
- A status pill: **LIVE**, **STALLED · DEAD AIR**, **STOPPED**, **OFFLINE** (with how long ago it was last heard from) or **NO DATA** (it has never reported). When a computer is sending the stream, the pill adds "sourced from" and that computer's name. Other computers that have the station open but are not sending show as "standby".
- When live: **Now Playing** with the title, artist and cover art.
- When not live: a one-line message, for example "Dead air — automation is running but nothing is on air."
- At the bottom: **Public page live** or **Private**.

If you belong to more than one account, the cards are grouped under each account's name. The list refreshes on its own every few seconds.

Add a new station

1. Press **+ New Station**.
2. Type the **Station name** (required). **Call letters** and **Frequency** are optional.
3. Press **▸ DEPLOY STATION**.
4. When it finishes, press **CLOSE — IT'LL SYNC TO YOUR DESKTOP SHORTLY**. The new station is created in your account, and each desktop signed in to the account picks it up.

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network (Control Center).

A station's page

Click a station card to open it. Press ← **All stations** to go back.

At the top: the station name, its status pill and, for Admins, **Edit settings**. If the station's last attempt to start streaming failed, the reason shows in a red line with how long ago it happened. The line goes away once the station is live again.

The monitor (left side)

The left side shows the station the way the desktop shows it:

- **DECK A, DECK B, DECK C** — each deck's song, with cover art. The deck that is on air says **ON AIR** and its color fills from left to right as the song plays, with the time played and the song length. The next deck to play pulses. The other decks say **CUED** or **EMPTY**.
- **Up Next** — the songs queued after the decks.
- **Announcements** — if the station runs announcements (Park stations), an announcement that is playing shows at the top as **ON AIR** with its seconds left. Coming announcements show in Up Next marked **ANN**, at the point where they will air. Below the monitor, **Announcements · tonight** lists

today's announcements with **Played**, **Failed** or **Skipped** and the time. This list is for watching only.

Reorder Up Next (Admins)

1. Drag a song in **Up Next** to a new position and let go.
2. A line under **Up Next** tells you what the station's computer answered. If it did not confirm the change, the list goes back to the order the station really has.

Only the Up Next songs move. The songs already on the decks stay where they are. Announcements cannot be dragged.

Plan (controls and reordering): Live 128, Live 320 or Network (Web remote).

The tabs (right side)

Station · Categories · Programming · Library · Listeners · Analytics · Affidavit

Station tab

Controls (Admins)

The **Controls** card first tells you which station and which computer a button will act on, for example "Acts on KETH · on STUDIO-1". If no computer is sending the stream, it names the computer that sent it last and when it went offline.

After every button, a line tells you what the station's computer answered: "✓ … done on STUDIO-1", "✗ STUDIO-1: (reason)", "STUDIO-1 is not connected — not sent", or "no answer from STUDIO-1 — not confirmed".

- **AUTO / MANUAL** — shows whether automation is running. Press it to turn automation on or off. It is greyed out when the station is offline.
- ⏭ **Skip** — moves on to the next song now.
- ▶ **Play now** — puts the next song on air right away. Use it to get out of dead air. It stands out when the station is stalled, and it is greyed out when the station is already live or offline.
- ↻ **Restart** — restarts the stream on the computer that is sending it. Press **Yes, restart** to confirm. Listeners drop for a few seconds. Automation and the song keep playing.
- ■ **Stop** — stops the station. This silences it on air. Press **Yes, stop** to confirm.
- ◉ **Start streaming** — makes the station's computer start sending the stream. Press **Yes, start streaming** to confirm. If another computer is already sending it, the dashboard tells you to take it off air there first.
- ◉ **ON AIR · (computer name)** — shown while the station is on air. Press it, then **Yes, off air**, to take it off the air.
- ⇄ **Move broadcast** — shown while the station is on air. See below.

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network (Web remote).

Move the broadcast to another computer (Admins)

Use this to hand the stream from one studio computer to another. Listeners hear about 1 to 3 seconds of silence while it switches.

1. Press ⇄ **Move broadcast**.
2. **Step 1:** pick the computer to move to. Each computer on the account is listed. "online (on air)" means it is sending a station right now. Otherwise it shows when it was last seen and "may be offline".
3. **Step 2:** press ■ **Take off air on (current computer)**, then **Yes, take off air**. Wait for "✓ Released — the mount is free."
4. **Step 3:** press ◉ **Start streaming on (new computer)**, then confirm. When it shows "✓ On air from (new computer). Handoff complete." press **Done**.
5. If the new computer does not go live, press ↩ **Put (original computer) back on**, then **Yes, restore**.

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network (Web remote).

Station details

The **Station** card shows the **Public page** address (or "Private (not published)"), the **Stream URL**, the date it was **Created** and the **Station ID**.

Embed widgets

When the public listener page is on, an **Embed widgets** card gives you two pieces of code to paste into your own website:

- **Now Playing** — the song on air and a Listen button.
- **Recently Played** — a list of the last songs played.

1. Press **Copy** next to the one you want. It changes to "Copied ✓".
2. Paste it into your website's page.
3. To change the look, add `&theme=light` or `&accent=%23ff5500` (any color) to the address inside the code.

Plan: Local (every plan) — Public listener page, account hub, embeds. (The dashboard that shows this card needs Live 128, Live 320 or Network.)

Edit settings (Admins)

Edit settings opens **Station settings**:

- **Display name** — the name shown on the public page.
- **Public page slug** — the last part of the station's listener address. Lowercase letters, numbers and hyphens. The dashboard checks it as you type and shows "✓ available", "✗ taken" or "✗ not a valid slug".
- **Primary color** and **Secondary color**.
- **Description**.
- **Ethercast category** — **Music**, **Talk**, **Sports** or **Uncategorized**.
- **Stream URL (Icecast / Shoutcast)**.
- **Logo** — choose a PNG, JPG or WebP image.
- **Website**, **Instagram**, **Twitter**, **Facebook**, **Youtube** — optional links.
- **Public listener page enabled** — turns the station's public page on or off. It needs a slug.

Press **Save settings**.

Delete a station. At the bottom, under **Danger zone**, press **Delete station**, type the station name exactly, and press **Delete station** again. This removes the station and all of its data. It cannot be undone.

Plan: Local (every plan) for the public page settings (they are also on the desktop); Live 128, Live 320 or Network to reach them here.

Categories tab

Shows the station's music categories: color, code, name, spins per hour and priority. Changes you make here are sent to the station's computer, which saves them in Ether and sends the updated list back. The list refreshes every few seconds, so a change appears once the station has applied it.

Add a category (Admins)

1. Press **+ Add**.
2. Fill in **Code** and **Name** (both required), pick a color, and optionally **Spins/hr** and **Prio**.
3. Press **Add**.

Change or delete (Admins) — press **Edit** on a row, change it, press **Save**. Press **Delete** and confirm to remove it.

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network (Control Center).

Programming tab

Two cards: **Dayparts** and **Clocks**. As on the Categories tab, every change goes to the station's computer and shows here once it has been applied.

Dayparts

Each daypart shows its name and hours, seven day buttons (**S M T W T F S**) and the clock it uses.

- Click a day button to turn that day on or off (Admins).
- Pick a different clock from the dropdown, or **— No clock —** (Admins).

New dayparts are made in Ether on the desktop. They appear here once the station sends them.

Clocks

Each clock shows its color, name, number of slots and total minutes. Click a clock to open its slots.

Add a clock (Admins): press **+ Add clock**, type the **Clock name**, pick a color, press **Add**. **Rename or recolor:** press **Edit**, then **Save**. **Delete:** press **Delete** and confirm. Any daypart using that clock is set to no clock.

Slots inside a clock (Admins)

Each slot shows its position, its type (**Music**, **Spots**, **Talk**, **Liner** or **Sweeper**), its category or label, and its length in minutes. A ■ means the clock stops after that slot.

1. Press **+ Add slot**.
2. Pick the type. For **Music**, pick a **Category** (required). For the others, type a **Label**.

3. Set the minutes.
4. Press ⏩ **Segue** to switch it to ■ **Stop** (stop after this slot), or back.
5. Press **Add**.

Use ↑ and ↓ to move a slot, **Edit** to change it, and ✕ to remove it.

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network (Control Center).

Library tab

Shows the station's songs with **Title**, **Artist**, **Category**, **Rotation** and **Time**. Type in the search box to filter by title, artist, album or category. Up to 250 songs show at once; search to narrow it down.

A line at the top shows how many songs are backed up to the cloud, how many are only in the cloud and not yet on the studio computer ("cloud-only (pending local)"), and how many are only on the studio computer ("local-only").

If the station has no songs of its own yet but has been given access to another account's library, the dashboard shows those songs instead, marked **Borrowed from the granted library (read-only)**.

Edit a song (Admins)

1. Click a song's row.
2. Change **Title**, **Category**, **Rotation** (active or inactive), **Energy**, **Genre**, **BPM** or **Explicit**.
3. Press **Save**.

Category, rotation and energy apply to this station only. Title, genre, BPM and explicit are shared with the other stations that use the same song.

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network (Control Center).

Load a song to a deck or the queue (Admins)

Each row has **A**, **B**, **C** and **Q** buttons.

- **A**, **B** or **C** cues the song on that deck of the station's computer, ready to play (it does not start playing).
- **Q** adds the song to the end of the queue.

A line under the header tells you what the station's computer answered. These work on the station that is currently open in Ether on that computer.

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network (Web remote).

Add a new song (Admins)

1. Press **+ Add song**.
2. Choose the **Audio file** (MP3, FLAC, WAV, M4A, AAC or OGG). The **Title** fills in from the file name.
3. Check the **Title**, add the **Artist**, and pick a **Category** if you want.
4. Press **Add song**. The audio uploads to your cloud library and the station's computer adds it to the library. It downloads the audio the first time it plays it.

Pull cloud-only songs to the studio computer (Admins)

When some songs are only in the cloud, a ↓ **Pull from cloud (number)** button appears.

1. Press it and confirm.
2. The studio computer downloads those songs in the background. The counts update as it finishes.

Plan (add song, pull from cloud): Live 128, Live 320 or Network (Cloud music library).

Listeners tab

The **Audience Report** for the station. Pick **7 days**, **30 days**, **90 days** or **All**.

- Totals: **listening now**, **sessions**, **unique listeners**, **listening hours**, **avg session** and **peak concurrent**.
- **Listeners over time** and **When they tune in (hour of day)** — move the mouse over a bar to see its number. Hours are in UTC.
- **Where they're listening from** — a world map. Move over a country or US state to see its listeners, click to zoom in, press ⤢ **Reset view** to zoom back out. Bubbles show who is listening right now.
- **Top countries**, **Top states / regions** and **Top cities**.

These numbers come from people who open your public listener page. They are private: only you see them.

Press 🖶 **Print / PDF** to print the report or save it as a PDF.

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network (Web analytics, affidavit, listenership).

Analytics tab

The **Playout Report**. Pick **7 days**, **30 days**, **90 days** or **All time**.

- **plays** and **content aired**.
- **Plays per day**.
- **Top songs** and **Top artists** (top 10 each).
- **By category**.
- **Recent playout** — the latest songs with their time and category.

It fills in as the station's computer sends its play log. Press 🖶 **Print / PDF** to print it.

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network (Web analytics, affidavit, listenership).

Affidavit tab

Proof of Performance for your advertisers. Pick **7 days**, **30 days**, **90 days** or **All time**.

- Totals: **spots aired**, **advertisers** and **unique spots**.
- **By advertiser** — click an advertiser to show only that advertiser's affidavit. Press ← **All advertisers** to go back.
- **Spots aired** — each spot with advertiser, ISCI code, length, spins, first and last time aired.
- **As-run log** — every airing with its time.

Each aired spot is matched to its advertiser through the spot's audio file. Press **Print / PDF** to print an advertiser's affidavit.

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network (Web analytics, affidavit, listenership).

Account

- **Account**, **Plan** and **Billing email**.

Your hub

One public page that lists all your stations, so listeners can switch between them.

1. Under **Hub logo**, press **Upload logo** (set the hub address first).
2. Type the **Hub name** — it shows above your stations.
3. Type the **Hub address** — the part after `/@`. It fills in from the name until you change it. The dashboard shows "✓ Available", "Already taken", or the rule (3 to 32 lowercase letters, numbers or hyphens).
4. Press **Save**. It then shows "✓ Live at" and the address.

You can change the hub name at any time. After you change the hub address, you have to wait 30 days before you can change it again. Old addresses keep working and send listeners to the new one.

Plan: Local (every plan) — Public listener page, account hub, embeds.

Billing

If your license is paid through a card subscription, this shows its **Status** and the date it **Renews** (or **Ends**). Press **Manage billing** to update your card, see invoices, or change or cancel your plan on the payment provider's secure page. A lifetime or manually issued key shows "No active Stripe subscription on this license".

Users (Admins only)

Lists the people who can sign in to the dashboard with a username and PIN: their name, username, role (**Admin** or **User**) and whether they are locked out. "you" marks your own entry. This page is a list only. People are added in Ether on the desktop, and they appear here once they have a PIN.

Plan: Live 128, Live 320 or Network (Control Center).

Good to know

- **Edits travel through the station's computer.** Category, clock, daypart and library changes go to the station's computer running Ether, which saves them and sends them back. The dashboard shows a change only after that round trip. If the station's computer is off, the change is not applied.
- **Controls go to one computer.** A control goes only to the computer that sends that station's stream (or sent it last). If that computer is not connected, the dashboard says "not connected — not sent". Nothing is queued for later.
- **"Not confirmed" means just that.** If the station's computer does not answer within about 8 seconds, the dashboard says "no answer … — not confirmed". Check the station before trying again.

- **A, B, C, Q and Up Next reordering** act on the station that is currently open in Ether on that computer. If that computer has another station open, it refuses and the dashboard shows the reason.
- **Stop silences the station on air.** Restart drops listeners for a few seconds. Moving the broadcast causes 1 to 3 seconds of silence.
- **Deleting a station** from **Edit settings** removes it and all its data, and cannot be undone.
- The **Users** page cannot add people or change PINs. Do that in Ether on the desktop.

26. The listener page

What it's for

The listener page is your station's public web player. Anyone with the link can open it on a phone, tablet or computer and listen live. It shows the song on air with its cover art, what is coming up, your other stations, your links and your social accounts, all in your station's colors and logo. Listeners can add it to their phone's home screen like an app. You can also put a small "now playing" or "recently played" box on your own website.

Where to find it

The page lives at **listen.ether-technologies.com/** followed by your station's address (its "slug"), for example `listen.ether-technologies.com/my-station`.

You turn it on and set it up in one of two places:

- In Ether on the desktop: **File** → **Settings** → **Station** → **Public Listener Page**.
- In the web dashboard: open the station, press **Edit settings** (see chapter 25).

Plan: Local (every plan) — Public listener page, account hub, embeds; and Now-playing for the listener page.

Turn the page on (in Ether on the desktop)

1. Open **File** → **Settings** and pick **Station** on the left.
2. Find **Public Listener Page**.
3. Turn on **Publish a public listener page**.
4. Type an **Address** — the slug. Ether checks it as you type and shows **Available** or the reason it can't be used.
5. Fill in the rest (all optional):
   - **Display name** — shown on the page. It can differ from your station name.
   - **Stream URL** — your stream's mount name, the part after `stream.ether-technologies.com:8443/`.
   - **Logo** — **Upload** a PNG, JPG or WebP image.
   - **Colors** — primary and secondary.
   - **Description** — a short tagline.
   - **Social Links** — your website and social accounts.
   - **Links** — named buttons on the page, for example a "Donate" button. Press **+ Add link**, type a **Label** and an address starting with `https://`. Press **Remove** to take one off.
6. Press **Save & Publish**. When it shows "✓ Published" and the address, the page is live.

Under **Your listener page**, press **Copy** to copy the address or **Open** to see it.

To take the page down, turn **Publish a public listener page** off and press **Save**. The page then says "Station not found".

File → **Settings** → **Links** also lists the address of each of your public pages, with **Open** and **Copy**.

The web dashboard's **Edit settings** has the same switch (**Public listener page enabled**) and most of the same fields. Named links are set in Ether on the desktop.

What listeners see

The station page

- **Your stations** — a row of square tiles, one for each of your published stations, under your hub name. Each tile shows the song on air (or **Live** or **Off air**), the artist and the station name. Tap a tile to start that station. Tap the playing tile again to pause. The tiles refresh about every 30 seconds.
- **Links** — your named buttons. Links set on any of your stations show on every one of your station pages.
- **Social links** at the bottom. Your website shows with its own icon and its address.

The player bar (bottom)

- The cover art, the song title and the artist. If nothing is on air it says **Off air**. If the station has no stream address yet it says **Stream not set up yet** and the play button is greyed out.
- The **play / pause** button. A spinner shows while the stream connects.
- A **volume** slider. The page remembers the volume on that device.
- The **full screen** button. Tapping the song in the bar also opens full screen.

Full screen

- Large cover art with the artist and title. **OFF AIR** shows over the art when nothing is on air.
- Your named links under the title.
- ‹ and › at the top switch to your previous or next station without stopping the sound.
- On the right, two tabs:
  - **Queue** — **Now playing**, then **Next from:** your station, listing the songs coming up.
  - **Recently played** — the songs that played while this listener had the page open. It starts empty each time the page is opened.
- Press the exit button or **Esc** to leave full screen.

On a phone

- Sound keeps playing when the screen locks or the listener switches apps. The lock screen shows the song, the art and play/pause controls.
- If a phone call interrupts, the page reconnects to the live stream when the listener comes back.
- Listeners can add the page to their home screen. It opens straight to your station.
- When someone shares the link in a text message or on social media, the preview shows your organization's name and the station's art.

The hub page

Your account hub is at **listen.ether-technologies.com/@** followed by your hub address, for example `listen.ether-technologies.com/@my-network`. It shows your hub logo and name and a card for each published station, with a live dot and the song on air (or **Offline**). Clicking a card opens that station's page. You set the hub name, address and logo in the web dashboard under **Account** → **Your hub** (chapter 25).

Messages listeners may see

- **Ether Radio — Open your station's link to start listening.** The address has no station in it.
- **Station not found.** No published station has that address.
- **Can't reach the station** with a **Retry** button. The page could not load the station.
- **Hub not found.** No account has that hub address.

Put now-playing on your own website (embeds)

There are two boxes you can paste into your own website:

- **Now Playing** — the song on air, art and a Listen button.
- **Recently Played** — the last songs played, with their times, and a **Listen live** → link.

1. In the web dashboard, open the station. On the **Station** tab, find **Embed widgets** (it shows only when the public page is on).
2. Press **Copy** next to the box you want.
3. Paste the code into your website.
4. Optional: add `&theme=light` for a light background, or `&accent=%23ff5500` (any color code) to change the accent color. For **Recently Played**, `&limit=` sets how many songs show (1 to 50, 8 if you leave it out).

The boxes refresh on their own. If the station's page is turned off, the box says **Station unavailable**.

Good to know

- **Changes can take up to a minute to show** on the page after you save them.
- **The stream must be set.** Without a stream address the page shows **Stream not set up yet** and cannot play.
- **Now-playing comes from the station's computer.** The song, art and queue show what Ether on the studio computer reports. If that computer is off, the page shows **Off air**.
- **Cover art.** The page uses the art from the song file when there is one, otherwise it looks the song up. Station imaging and commercials never get a looked-up cover; they show your logo instead.
- **Brand.** The browser tab and the phone's lock screen show your organization's name followed by "Radio", taken from your hub name, on every station page.
- **Listener numbers are private.** Each listener is counted without names or addresses. You see the counts in the web dashboard's **Listeners** tab. Nothing is shown to the public.
- **Some stations have their own page design.** A few stations have a custom-designed page in place of the standard one (currently the stations at `/magical-forest` and `/halloween`). These are made by Ether Technologies for that station; there is no setting to pick a design.
- **Jukebox pages** (`/jukebox/…`) live on the same site. See chapter 17.